

Bishpan

The son of a Pujari murdered for stealing Kali Mata's eyes returns from Bhubaneswar to Rambhadipur, where the guilty start dying one by one, not knowing that the Goddess is taking her revenge through him.

EPISODE 1: CITY'S SHADOW

SCENE 1

INT. AARAV'S BHUBANESWAR APARTMENT - DAY

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA, SATYAVATI, DURGA

A modern apartment in Bhubaneswar. Morning sunlight streams through a large window into the kitchen. Paratha and curry are laid out on the dining table with toast and cereal.

AARAV (30, software engineer, in smart jeans and T-shirt) pours hot tea into a mug.

PRIYA (28, Aarav's wife, in fashionable clothes) scrolls through her mobile. Her brow is furrowed, lost in thought.

SATYAVATI (55, Aarav's mother, in a simple sari) serves parathas onto everyone's plates. DURGA (80, Aarav's grandmother, in a white sari) sits quietly, listening to them.

PRIYA

Aarav, what did Sir say about your promotion? It's a sure thing this time.

AARAV

Yes, he did. But what's the point of just that promotion? How much longer will I keep running in this 'corporate race'?

PRIYA

Why? Who will pay the down payment for our new flat? We're planning to have a child within the next two years.

AARAV

That's all fine. But I want to do something of my own. A startup... take my own idea forward.

SATYAVATI

Why, son? Such a good job, good salary. You live in the city, what more do you want? Startups... these aren't good.

PRIYA

Mom, you won't understand. This is the 'trend' these days.

Durga's hand holding the cup begins to tremble slightly.

She clenches her fist, trying to steady the cup. Her fingers look bloodless.

The shaking intensifies. The cup slips from her hand, hits the table, and shatters on the floor. The sound of breaking glass silences the

whole house.

Everyone's eyes flick from the broken cup to Durga.

SATYAVATI

Mom!

Durga's face slackens. Her mouth falls open. She clutches her forehead with both hands.

A faint sound escapes her lips. She struggles to breathe, her chest heaving. She leans forward from her chair.

DURGA

Ram Bhadrapur... stolen eyes...

Aarav stands up to catch her. Durga slides onto the floor beside the table.

Aarav kneels on the floor, pulling Durga's head into his lap.

PRIYA

Aarav!

AARAV

Grandma! What happened? Mom, call an ambulance.

Satyavati's hand trembles. The phone almost slips from her grasp. She looks at Aarav, bewildered.

SCENE 2

INT. BHUBANESWAR HOSPITAL ROOM - DAY

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA, SATYAVATI, DURGA, DOCTOR

Inside a silent hospital room, DURGA (80, frail, her breathing labored) lies unconscious on a medical bed. A faint, rhythmic 'beep... beep' emanates from a monitor.

Beside the bed, AARAV (30, his brow furrowed with worry) gazes at his mother. PRIYA (28, stands with slumped shoulders, a flicker of fear on her face) holds Aarav's hand. SATYAVATI (55, her eyes are puffy, lines of worry etched on her face) leans against the wall.

A DOCTOR (40, crisp white coat, carrying a report) enters the room.

DOCTOR

Aarav Babu?

AARAV

Yes, Doctor. How is Mother? Any good news...?

DOCTOR

(ଧୀର ସ୍ବରରେ)

Look, Mousi suffered a very severe stroke. A large part of her brain is critically damaged. [parenthetical: in

a low voice]

SATYAVATI

(ଆଗକୁ ଆସି)

Will my mother get better, Doctor?

Will everything be alright again?

[parenthetical: steps forward]

DOCTOR

We're providing the best treatment.

But given her age, and the severity of the stroke...

The Doctor's voice trails off, tinged with disappointment. He looks down.

DOCTOR

Modern medicine has its limits. The chances of a full recovery are practically nil.

Aarav's hand clenches into a fist. His eyes fix on the floor for a moment.

PRIYA

Aarav... are you hearing what the Doctor is saying?

SATYAVATI

Such a big hospital... such a renowned doctor... there's no way? We can't do anything else?

DOCTOR

She's on life support now. She'll need extensive treatment and physiotherapy for a long time. But we can't guarantee any recovery.

Satyavati closes her eyes. Her shoulders tremble.

Aarav lifts his head, looking at Durga's vacant face. He grips the metal railing of the bed.

AARAV

What else can we do, Doctor? Is there no other option?

DOCTOR

All I can say is, there's not much more in our hands now. It's only in God's hands now.

The Doctor shakes his head and exits the room.

Satyavati covers her face with her hands and begins to cry. Her sobs are silent, but her shoulders shake.

Priya looks into Aarav's eyes. A deep worry is etched on her face.

SCENE 3

INT. AARAV'S BHUBANESWAR APARTMENT - DAY

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA, SATYAVATI

Inside the quiet, a normal dining table. AARAV (30, smart casual shirt, looking conflicted), PRIYA (28, modern dress, practical), and SATYAVATI (55, calm, in a simple sari) sit around it. The breakfast plates before them remain untouched.

Deep dark circles under SATYAVATI's eyes, proof of sleepless nights. She clutches her teacup with both hands, her knuckles white.

SATYAVATI

The doctor has given up... How much
longer can we just sit here in silence?

A tear rolls down her cheek, unheeded. She looks straight at AARAV, her eyes pleading.

SATYAVATI

Let's take Mother to Ramadrapur.

PRIYA's fork clatters onto her plate. She sits up abruptly, taking a deep breath.

PRIYA

What are you saying, Aunty? In this
day and age... to the village?

PRIYA

Who's there to look after her?

SATYAVATI shakes her head, her lips set firmly.

SATYAVATI

What would you understand, PRIYA? That
soil has its own strength.

SATYAVATI

Mother Kali's blessings are always
there.

Images of the distant past flash in her eyes.

SATYAVATI

Don't you remember what Mom said when
she fainted that day? 'Ramadrapur... a
hidden eye...'

AARAV's hand freezes mid-air, a piece of biscuit crumbling from his fingers.

He slowly looks up at SATYAVATI.

A deep crease forms between his eyebrows.

He pushes his plate away with a scraping sound.

He looks at a childhood photo hanging on the wall - DURGA smiling in front of the village temple.

PRIYA

Aunty, that's all nonsense! She wasn't thinking straight then.

PRIYA

People say the most irrational things when they're sick.

She leans forward, trying to meet AARAV's eyes.

PRIYA

AARAV, have you ever thought about it? That village... those old stories... we have nothing to do with them anymore.

PRIYA

How can we take a sick person there?

AARAV picks up his glass, swirling the water.

He doesn't look at anyone, his attention fixed on the swirling water in the glass.

He takes a long, shaky breath.

SATYAVATI reaches across the table, her trembling hand touching AARAV's arm.

Her voice breaks, tears streaming down her face.

SATYAVATI

AARAV! You're her grandson. Your ancestors are from there.

SATYAVATI

There's no other way. This is the last hope to save her.

She grips AARAV's arm tightly.

SATYAVATI

I can't let my mother go like this, AARAV... Please...

AARAV closes his eyes for a moment, letting out a deep sigh.

His chest rises and falls. He looks at SATYAVATI's tear-streaked face, then at her trembling shoulders.

AARAV

Okay, Ma.

His lips press together firmly.

AARAV

I'll take her to Ramadrapur.

A great weight seems to lift from SATYAVATI's shoulders. Relief washes over her face.

PRIYA gasps, staring at AARAV with wide eyes.

She bites her lip hard. Her fingernails dig into the edge of the dining table.

SCENE 4

EXT. BHUBANESWAR COFFEE SHOP - DAY

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA

AARAV (30) and PRIYA (28) sit at a table by the window in a coffee shop in Bhubaneswar. Outside, car horns blare. Inside, the gentle hum of a coffee grinder mixes with low conversations. Aarav traces a water droplet on the table with his finger. Priya cradles her coffee mug, steam misting her eyes.

Priya sets her mug down, her fingers lingering on the handle. Aarav stares blankly out the window at the passing traffic.

PRIYA

Aarav, have you really decided to go to Ramabhadrapur?

Aarav turns from the window. His brow furrows.

AARAV

When my mother asked, I couldn't say no.

Priya reaches out and touches Aarav's hand on the table. Her voice softens.

PRIYA

But what about our future? All the dreams we had for this job, for our home...

Priya leans forward slightly, her lips trembling.

PRIYA

That village... it's full of old ways. Not good. You'll put yourself in danger.

Aarav looks down at his cold coffee mug. His finger circles the rim.

PRIYA

Aarav, please... let's not leave all this for some unknown place. I'm scared.

Priya covers Aarav's hand with her own, squeezing it. A chill emanates from her hand into his.

Aarav places his hand over Priya's.

AARAV

Priya, I have to go. I can't stand seeing Didima like this. Mother thinks this is our last hope.

Priya pulls her hand away, as if the last bit of hope left her body. Her face goes blank.

PRIYA

So, you've made up your mind?

Aarav doesn't answer. He slowly lowers his head.

Priya lets out a long breath, as if releasing all the pain from her chest. She picks up her bag from the table.

PRIYA

Fine.

Priya stands up. Her lips tighten, tears welling in her eyes. Without another word, she walks out of the coffee shop.

Aarav remains seated. Before him, the empty coffee mug and Priya's half-finished cup. The surrounding chatter and laughter create a void for Aarav.

SCENE 5

INT. AARAV'S BHUBANESWAR APARTMENT - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, DURGA

AARAV (30s, in a blue t-shirt and jeans) stands amidst an open suitcase in a Bhubaneswar apartment, clothes, pants, and papers spilling out everywhere. It looks like he's packing in a hurry.

SATYAVATI (50s, in a white sari, her face etched with deep worry) carefully folds clothes and places them into the suitcase. Every movement of her hands is deliberate.

AARAV pulls a few thick books from his laptop bag and puts them into a separate packing bag. His expression is grim.

DURGA (80s, her face pale) lies still on the living room sofa. The faint sound of her breathing fills the room.

AARAV freezes. He stares at DURGA, a line of worry creasing his forehead.

As SATYAVATI packs, her hand brushes against a small, old wooden box.

She slowly opens the lid. Inside rests a tarnished, time-worn idol of Kali.

She picks up the idol with reverence. Her fingers trace the darkened metal, as if searching for a forgotten memory.

AARAV turns, surprised to see SATYAVATI holding the idol.

AARAV

Mom, what is this?

SATYAVATI

This is Maa Kali. The family deity.
Worshipped since our ancestors' time.

SATYAVATI wraps the idol in a faded red cloth. The fabric is old, its color almost gone.

AARAV

But we... we don't believe in all this anymore. We've left all that behind.

SATYAVATI looks up at AARAV. Her eyes hold an unspoken pain.

SATYAVATI

Some things, son, you can't forget. Even if you don't believe, you must honor them.

She places the wrapped idol into a small separate bag. Her hands tremble as she holds it.

AARAV watches her, a look of unease on his face. He wants to say something, but no words come out.

AARAV

You think all this... will help us?

SATYAVATI zips up the small bag. Her lips press together in a firm line.

SATYAVATI

It is Maa's will.

She turns and looks towards DURGA. Her lips move silently, as if reciting an unseen mantra.

AARAV looks first at DURGA, then at the packed suitcase, and finally at the small bag containing the idol.

The noise in the apartment fades. Only the sound of DURGA's breathing remains, carrying an invisible weight.

AARAV picks up a suitcase. His head dips slightly, as if he's carrying a heavy burden.

SCENE 6

EXT. BHUBANESWAR CITY OUTSKIRTS - DAY

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, DURGA, PRIYA

On the outskirts of Bhubaneswar, a white taxi is stopped.

AARAV puts a large bag into the car's trunk.

SATYAVATI (50, hair pulled back, wearing a simple cotton sari) approaches AARAV.

The rear door is open. Inside, DURGA breathes softly, as if dozing.

AARAV and SATYAVATI carefully help DURGA into the car. DURGA's head lolls to one side.

PRIYA (28, dressed in a smart top and jeans) watches from a distance. She stands stiffly, worry etched on her face.

AARAV closes the car door and walks over to PRIYA.

PRIYA

Will everything be okay? I have a bad feeling about this.

AARAV takes PRIYA's hand in his. A small, reassuring smile plays on his lips.

AARAV

Don't worry. I'll be back soon. I'll come back to you.

SATYAVATI calls to AARAV from inside the car.

SATYAVATI

Son, why the delay? Let's go.

AARAV releases PRIYA's hand. PRIYA's gaze falls to her empty hand.

AARAV looks back at PRIYA one last time. His eyes hold a silent farewell.

He gets into the car. The door closes with a soft thud.

The driver starts the engine.

PRIYA stands perfectly still, her eyes fixed on the car. Her lips begin to tremble slightly.

The car slowly pulls away, merging into the city roads and then disappearing.

PRIYA's hand drifts unconsciously to her chest. Tears well up in her eyes.

SCENE 7

EXT. DESERTED RURAL ROAD - DAY

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, DURGA, DRIVER

The car moves along a deserted road, flanked by dense, leafy forests. Sunlight struggles to penetrate the canopy, leaving the path in perpetual shadow.

Suddenly, the engine sputtered and died. The car lurched a few times and came to a halt.

The DRIVER grips the steering wheel tightly, his brow furrowed.

The engine's rumbling stops abruptly. A strange, unnerving silence settles over everything.

AARAV

What happened, brother? Why did we stop here?

The DRIVER turns the key. A hollow 'click-click' is all that answers. The car won't start.

The DRIVER shakes his head, a look of distress on his face.

DRIVER

I don't know, sir. It just stopped.
Didn't even hear any bad noises.

The DRIVER glances back at DURGA in the rear seat. DURGA's head lolls to the side. She's breathing, but seems deeply unsettled.

SATYAVATI

Oh God! What do we do now? Mother
isn't well.

AARAV opens the car door, his lips pressed into a thin line. He steps out.

He steps onto the ground. The surroundings are eerily silent. In the distance, the trees of the dense forest stand like a wall. A damp, unfamiliar scent drifts on the air.

AARAV opens the hood near the driver's seat. He peers inside, then places a hand on the engine.

He snatches his hand back as if burned. Goosebumps rise on AARAV's skin. He clutches his arms.

AARAV looks around, his head snapping up. The dense forest seems to press in on him, as if watching.

AARAV stares into the dark, thick woods with trembling eyes. His mouth feels dry.

Just then, a faint, fearful whimper comes from inside the car.

The sound makes AARAV jump. His blood runs cold.

He slams the hood shut and rushes back to the car, peering inside.

SATYAVATI clutches DURGA tightly in the back seat. DURGA's eyes are wide open.

Terror flashes across her face. DURGA's body trembles.

SATYAVATI

Mother! What is it? What's happening
to you?

DURGA covers her eyes with a weak hand. Her lips tremble, but no sound comes out.

AARAV sees that same fear in DURGA's eyes. His heart pounds.

He involuntarily glances back towards the dense forest. He sees only darkness and a looming shadow.

The shadows of the tree branches deepen. A gust of cold wind whips the car.

Fear lines AARAV's face. He braces himself for something.

SCENE 8

EXT. DESERTED RURAL ROAD - DAY

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, DURGA, DRIVER

AARAV slumps in the driver's seat. His hands grip the steering wheel, knuckles white.

He closes his eyes, takes a shaky breath.

The driver turns the key again. The engine coughs, then sputters, a metallic screech, but doesn't catch.

AARAV leans forward. His eyes fix on a small switch on the dashboard.

AARAV

Hey, flip that... that little switch.

The driver glances, then follows AARAV's gaze to the switch. He nods and presses it. A soft click.

The driver turns the key again. This time, the engine roars to life.

The car vibrates, the tremor running through the chassis.

SATYAVATI makes a small whimper and clasps her hands. The worry lines on her face ease slightly.

DURGA's eyes flutter open, but she doesn't seem to see anything. Her fingers twitch involuntarily.

SATYAVATI

By Mother Kali's grace.

AARAV checks the rearview mirror. SATYAVATI and DURGA are reflected there.

The fear hasn't left DURGA's face. Her lips are parted, her head still lolling.

AARAV bites his lip. He shakes his head, lets out a long breath.

AARAV

Drive slow, man.

The car lurches forward, slowly at first, then picks up speed.

AARAV glances in the rearview mirror again. DURGA's eyes are still open, but staring blankly.

A cold wave washes down his spine. Something inside him feels like it's being squeezed.

SCENE 9

EXT. RAMBHADIPUR VILLAGE ENTRANCE - DAY

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, DURGA, OLD MAN, VILLAGERS

An SUV screeches to a halt at the edge of the village, kicking up dust.

As the engine cuts out, an unnatural silence descends upon the village.

Only the faint echo of bells from a distant temple can be heard.

Figures emerge from the swirling dust. They are some of the villagers. Their eyes are blank, fixed on the vehicle with a long, unblinking stare.

AARAV (28, dressed in city clothes, but showing the weariness of the journey) steps out.

He takes a breath, the scent of baked earth and old trees filling his senses.

AARAV's lips tremble slightly. He looks up, his gaze sweeping over the small village houses.

Three faint lines appear on his forehead.

SATYAVATI (55, in a sari) opens the back door and helps DURGA (80, frail from illness) out.

DURGA sways, held tightly by SATYAVATI.

From the crowd, an elderly villager (70, wearing a traditional dhoti-kurta, with a white beard and mustache) slowly approaches.

His eyes hold a depth that offers no clues, as if he knows much but remains silent.

OLD MAN

You've arrived, son?

SATYAVATI

Yes, brother. We've finally made it after such a long journey.

AARAV rubs his hands together, a strange chill settling over him.

The villagers stand frozen, their shadowy forms deepening the somber atmosphere.

AARAV moves closer to DURGA. Seeing her sleeping form, his shoulders slump further.

He presses his lips together, clear worry etched on his face.

AARAV turns his head, looking towards the dusty old road where a faint image of his ancestral home can be seen.

His fingers clench together, his knuckles turning white.

SCENE 10

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, DURGA

The car stops in front of a dusty, abandoned house. AARAV (30, troubled, sweat-soaked shirt and pants) gets out, carrying DURGA (80,

unconscious) in his arms.

He glances at the old house's door. The paint is peeling, and the overgrown courtyard looks like a jungle.

AARAV's feet halt by the door. He hesitates to go inside, his brow furrowed.

SATYAVATI (55, in a simple sari, weary expression) stands behind him. In her hands, a small, tarnished idol of Kali.

SATYAVATI

Aren't you going in, son? We need to get Mother inside.

AARAV reaches out and gently pushes the broken door. It creaks open, revealing a dark interior.

The smell of old wood and dust hits him. Outside light streams in, illuminating dancing dust motes.

AARAV carries DURGA inside. The moment he steps into the house, a shiver runs down his spine.

A cold current travels down his spine. He exhales a puff of cold air.

SATYAVATI also enters, clutching the Kali idol to her chest.

AARAV lays DURGA down on a nearby old plank.

AARAV straightens up, his shoulders aching. His eyes scan every corner of the room as if searching for something.

A faint, soft humming sound is heard, like someone whispering.

AARAV's head snaps towards the source of the sound. He holds his breath.

The sound comes again, a little clearer this time.

CHARACTER (O.S.)

Eyes...

AARAV flinches. His hands instinctively go to his chest. Sweat beads on his forehead. He tries to steady himself.

SATYAVATI finds a small niche in the old wall.

She places the Kali idol there, fills a lamp with oil, and lights the wick.

She turns to AARAV.

SATYAVATI

What is it, son? Did you see something?

AARAV

No... nothing.

He averts his gaze from SATYAVATI. His lips tremble, and he turns his face to the wall.

EPISODE 2: VILLAGE WHISPERS

SCENE 1

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA, SATYAVATI, DURGA, ³<A³ A²Û>°rÃ ³ë ²ë9³û3³à

The faint sound of a car approaches from the main gate.

Raising dust from the old dirt road, the car pulls up near the house and stops.

AARAV (30, dressed in city clothes, looking innocent but with a troubled expression) and PRIYA (28, modern attire, wary in her eyes, uneasy on her face) step out of the car.

Behind them, SATYAVATI (55, in a simple saree, a shadow of sorrow on her face but a firm set to her lips) gets out.

Before them stands an old ancestral home. The plaster is peeling from the walls, the doors and windows are dilapidated.

AARAV glances into the house over the threshold.

The inside of the house looks dark.

SATYAVATI sighs, as if returning to her village after a long time.

A faint smile on her lips, but hidden pain in her eyes.

An elderly villager walks by in the distance, along the road.

He squints, looking in their direction.

SATYAVATI

Hey Surubhai, how are you?

Surubhai walks on, head down, without looking back.

Seeing this, PRIYA moves closer to AARAV.

Her face registers discomfort.

AARAV

What happened, Ma? Didn't he say anything?

SATYAVATI

No... no. Maybe he didn't hear.

They enter the house. It's disheveled inside. Layers of dust cover the floor.

In one room, DURGA (80, frail, sleeping) lies on a cot.

SATYAVATI sets down the luggage and goes to DURGA, stroking her head.

SATYAVATI

Everything will be alright now, Ma.
We're back.

The sound of dishes being washed comes from a nearby house.

Another village woman passes by outside, carrying a bundle of firewood on her head.

She too glances away quickly upon seeing them.

PRIYA

Ma... why is everyone here acting like this?

SATYAVATI says nothing.

She stares outside, a look of firm resolve on her face, but a deep helplessness in her eyes.

SCENE 2

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: PRIYA, AARAV

PRIYA (28, dressed in modern clothes) sits in a back room of the house. Dust covers everything.

She holds a mobile phone, her fingers swiping across the screen. A slight frown creases her forehead.

The search bar reads 'History of Ramabhadrapur Temple'.

A snippet appears: a digital link to an old newspaper. The headline reads: 'Temple Land Dispute: Strange Legal Battles Emerge'.

She taps the link.

A page from a newspaper, 15-20 years old, opens on her phone screen. The page is faded, the text tiny.

Her eyes scan line after line. Her eyebrows draw closer together.

The article details a dispute over the temple's land boundaries, old land transfer laws, and some 'rare' legal precedents.

One sentence catches her eye: 'This dispute began many years before the theft of Kali Mata's eyes.'

PRIYA's hand trembles. The phone slowly slips from her grasp into her lap.

In the silence of the empty room, she hears her heart pounding. The back of her neck feels cold.

AARAV (30, dressed in city clothes) enters the room.

AARAV

What are you doing?

PRIYA

Oh, when did you get here? You didn't make a sound?

AARAV

You were so lost in thought, you
didn't even notice me come in. What's
wrong?

PRIYA

I was looking up some things about
this village. And what I found...

Her voice trembles.

AARAV

What did you find? Bad news?

PRIYA

Long before Dad was framed for
stealing those eyes, there was so much
conflict over this temple land. There
was some news about old laws.

AARAV

Meaning? Does this have anything to do
with Dad?

PRIYA

I don't know... but the way these
villagers act, and these old
stories... I'm scared, Aarav. We need
to leave.

AARAV

Leave? Where? We just got here. Mom
likes it here.

PRIYA

Mom doesn't feel the same way I do.
Something isn't right here. I can feel
it.

SCENE 3

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, MAHANTA

A sturdy bicycle is parked by the gate.

MAHANTA (65, wearing a white silk kurta and dhoti, a sandalwood mark
on his forehead) enters the house. A wide smile on his face.

SATYAVATI (55, in a simple white sari, a look of peace on her face)
follows MAHANTA.

AARAV stands on the veranda, watching them.

MAHANTA

I'm so happy to hear you've arrived,
Satyavati. The house feels alive with
laughter again.

SATYAVATI

Welcome, Mahanta-babu, please come in.
It's been a long time since you
visited.

MAHANTA glances around the house, a strange gleam in his eyes.

MAHANTA

Well, well, isn't this our Aarav? How
big you've grown! The city air has
made you even more handsome.

MAHANTA walks over to AARAV.

MAHANTA

Aarav, have you forgotten our village
already?

AARAV

Greetings, Mahanta-babu. How are you?

MAHANTA

I'm doing well, son. Since your father
passed, the temple feels so empty. I
thought when you returned, those days
might come back.

SATYAVATI

With the grace of the Mother Goddess,
everything must be going well at the
temple.

MAHANTA

(ଏକ ଲୁଚା ହସ ହସି)

Yes, things are going well. But do you
know, Satyavati, every stone, every
speck of dust in this temple knows so
much. Who did what, when, who took
what, when... it's all right before my
eyes.

AARAV's breath catches at MAHANTA's words. A question forms on his
face.

SATYAVATI

You are the elder of this village. Who
would know better than you?

MAHANTA

(AARAV ଆଡ଼କୁ ଚାହିଁ)

You've spoken truly. This village
land, the temple grounds... I have the
paperwork for all of it. I remember
exactly who gave what to whom, where,
and when.

AARAV

Mahanta-babu, why are you talking
about the temple's papers?

MAHANTA

(ହସି ଦେଲେ, କିନ୍ତୁ ଆଖିରେ ଚମକ)
Nothing, Son. Just remembering old times. And I thought, since you've returned, perhaps you'd be interested in knowing some things too.

SATYAVATI

(କଥା ବଦଳାଇବାକୁ ଚେଷ୍ଟା କଲେ)
Would you like some tea, Mahanta-babu?

SCENE 4

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

Night has fallen. AARAV (30) sits on his bed, staring at the old wall of his room.

His eyes aren't focused on anything in particular, just gazing blankly into space.

Suddenly, he feels like something is stuck in his throat. An unknown pressure tightens his neck.

He clutches his neck with his hands. His muscles are stiffening.

He struggles to draw a breath. A bead of sweat rolls down his forehead.

His eyelids remain half-open. The room seems to spin around him.

His limbs grow limp. All strength drains from his body.

A bitter, metallic taste floods his tongue. He puts a hand over his mouth.

His face contorts as if he's about to vomit. He slumps off the bed.

His eyelids close. He lies there, lifeless, on the floor.

After a while, AARAV's eyes slowly flutter open. His vision is blurry.

He stares at the ceiling for a long time, as if he doesn't understand anything.

His fingers tremble. He tries to get up, but his body won't cooperate.

A dry cough escapes his throat, as if something is lodged there.

His chest heaves heavily. His tongue feels dry.

He touches his mouth again. That metallic taste is still there.

He scans the room with his eyes, everything feels unfamiliar. A large chunk of time is missing.

He reaches out and grips the side of the bed. He painfully pulls himself up to a sitting position, his body tingling.

He places a hand on his chest, feeling the rapid beat of his heart.

He touches his throat with his hand, the memory of that pressure still feels real.

His brow furrows. He looks around the corners of the room, as if searching for something.

He has no idea what happened. A deep confusion is etched on his face.

SCENE 5

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, DURGA

AARAV (28, anxious, agitated) sits on the bed. His chest rises and falls rapidly.

He brings his hand to his throat, as if gripping it. Then touches his lips with a finger, as if an unnatural taste still lingers there.

His eyes dart around the room. He's trying to steady himself.

In the corner of the room, on a cot, lies DURGA (80, frail, wearing a white sari).

Her eyelids slowly flutter open.

First, everything is blurry in the darkness, then the image sharpens.

DURGA's gaze fixes on AARAV.

Her breath catches. A tremor runs through her body.

The muscles in her face tighten. Her eyes fill with deep terror.

She clutches her chest, fingers clenching as if digging into herself.

A faint, inarticulate sound escapes her throat.

That sound makes AARAV suddenly turn his head.

He looks at DURGA. Confusion and worry cloud his face.

DURGA's terror intensifies. She tries to push herself further back on the cot, as if to keep AARAV away.

Her eyes lock onto AARAV's throat. Seeing that spot, her fear doubles.

AARAV takes a step towards her.

DURGA shakes her head weakly, a silent 'no'.

Her eyes roll back up. All expression drains from her face.

DURGA loses consciousness again.

But her eyes remain slightly open, still fixed on AARAV's throat.

AARAV remains frozen. A chill runs through him.

His hand unconsciously drifts back to his throat, where he felt the

pressure moments before.

SCENE 6

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, DURGA

AARAV (30, dressed in urban jeans and shirt, sharp look) was sleeping face down. Suddenly, his body jolted.

He sat up with a start. His eyes fluttered open and shut again, darting around disoriented.

The pale morning light floods the room through the window. Dust motes dance in the air like atoms.

He held his head in his hands, shaking it slightly, as if trying to clear his thoughts.

His throat felt dry. He squeezed his throat lightly with his hand, trying to swallow.

A faint cough escaped him.

A shiver ran down his spine. He pulled the blanket closer, feeling cold even in the summer heat.

His gaze drifted from the bed to his hands. He turned his palms over, looking at them as if they weren't his own.

His lips trembled.

He tried to say something, but no sound came out.

His eyes fell on DURGA, sleeping on the other side of the bed.

FLASH - AARAV'S POV: The same fear, the same terror that was on DURGA's face last night flashed in his mind again.

He flinched, a tremor running through his body.

AARAV gripped his head with both hands. He stared blankly at the floor.

He dangled his feet over the side of the bed. His legs trembled. He slid down to sit against the wall.

AARAV

What is all this... What's happening
to me?

His voice trembled with fear. His eyes held the frustration of not finding any answers.

SCENE 7

EXT. RAMBHADIPUR VILLAGE SQUARE - DAY

Characters: AARAV, VILLAGER 1, VILLAGER 2, OLD WOMAN

Dust kicks up from the dirt road of the village outskirts. On one side, a vegetable stall buzzes with activity. A few customers mill around an old woman selling produce.

AARAV (30s, dressed in pants and a shirt) stumbles as if he's walked into a pole. He's not paying attention.

A frown creases his forehead. He looks up towards the sun. His eyes sting.

The indistinct chatter of three or four villagers gathered nearby drifts towards AARAV.

His feet stop dead in the middle of the road. He strains to hear what they're saying.

VILLAGER 1

They say he died of a snakebite... but
Bipin wasn't the kind of man to just
go like that.

VILLAGER 1 (40s, wearing a dhoti, looking frail) glances around. His voice is low.

VILLAGER 2

That's what I'm thinking too. Who gets
bitten by a snake for no reason these
days? Especially him.

VILLAGER 2 (30s, wearing a gamchha, looking sturdy) wears a strange expression on his face.

AARAV's fists clench. His fingers turn white.

OLD WOMAN

How many people in this village have
had their mouths shut, and nobody knew
why.

OLD WOMAN (70s, hunched, wearing a faded sari) shuffles closer to the vendor, clutching a broken basket. Her voice is raspy.

VILLAGER 1

But this time, I heard Bipin had some
papers. About the temple lands.

AARAV gasps, his breath catching. His gaze is fixed on them.

VILLAGER 2

What papers? Didn't Bipin testify
against our priest father back then?

VILLAGER 1

Yes, that's right. Now they say he
wanted to dig up that old story again.

About the temple's valuable assets and
land dealings.

VILLAGER 1 presses his lips together. He squints.

AARAV bites down on his lower lip.

OLD WOMAN

Whatever belongs to the Goddess Kali
cannot be taken by anyone. The
consequences of sin will surely be met.

AARAV scrapes his foot along the ground. Small pebbles crunch.

Everyone looks around, startled. The conversation dies mid-sentence.
In an instant, the crowd disperses.

VILLAGER 1 grabs his bicycle and hurries away. VILLAGER 2 abandons
his half-bought greens and flees.

AARAV

Hey, Auntie... are you listening?

The OLD WOMAN is packing vegetables into a sack. She doesn't look at
AARAV. Fear lines her face.

OLD WOMAN

This village soil holds many secrets.
Everything is buried beneath the
earth. If you dig it up... it's only
danger.

The OLD WOMAN clutches the sack of vegetables to her chest. She
lowers her head and walks away quickly.

AARAV stands frozen, the area around him deserted. His gaze is fixed
on the distant temple spire.

His fists clench tighter. His jaw tightens.

SCENE 8

INT. RAMBHADIPUR POLICE STATION - DAY

Characters: AARAV, INSPECTOR

AARAV (30) sits on an old wooden chair inside the police station. An
empty table is in front of him. A map of Odisha hangs on the wall.
The sound of files being opened comes from the back. The room feels
hot and stuffy.

An Inspector (40, stout, tired eyes) emerges, holding a glass of
water.

INSPECTOR

Sir... what happened? Your name?

AARAV

My name is Aarav. Sir, I've come to
discuss Bipin's death.

The Inspector pulls up a chair and sits. Annoyance creases his face.

INSPECTOR

Oh, Bipin's case is closed. The report says he died of a snakebite. What's left to discuss?

AARAV

No, sir. I don't think this was just a normal death. I heard in the village... he knew something about the temple land and some documents.

The Inspector starts opening files. His eyes are on the files, not on Aarav.

INSPECTOR

Look, Mr. Aarav, you hear all sorts of things in this village. Old land disputes... the police don't get involved in all that. What's in the report is the truth.

AARAV

But... Bipin testified against my father. That was about the temple land too. And now his death... so sudden?

Aarav leans forward slightly. He is filled with a mix of eagerness and suspicion.

INSPECTOR

Sir, nobody asks permission before they die. Forget all this old stuff. Or you'll end up in trouble for nothing.

The Inspector closes the file. He doesn't look at Aarav.

AARAV

I want to clear the stain on my father's name. There's a mystery behind this death.

The Inspector sighs, as if weary.

INSPECTOR

Whatever it is, his time is up. You should go your own way.

Aarav's face hardens. His brow furrows. He stands up from the chair.

AARAV

This is my way. I won't rest until I know the truth.

Aarav walks out of the station. His steps are firm, his eyes hold a new resolve. The sun is intense in the station courtyard.

CUT TO:

SCENE 9

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA, SATYAVATI

Darkness seeps in through the window into the living room of Aarav's ancestral home. The air is heavy with the scent of incense wafting from the prayer room.

SATYAVATI (50) sits on one side of an old wooden bed, a lamp lit beside her. She holds a string of prayer beads. The dim lamplight falls on her face.

PRIYA (28) paces restlessly around the room. Her breathing is quickening.

AARAV (30) sits on a mat in a corner of the room. His eyes are fixed on the deep darkness outside the window. His hands are clenched on his lap.

PRIYA

I can't stay here anymore, Ma! Aarav,
can you hear me? We have to leave.
Right now.

Priya comes and stands beside Aarav. Aarav doesn't look away from the darkness. His body is rigid, staring into space.

SATYAVATI

What are you saying, daughter-in-law?
This is our ancestral home. The land
of our fathers and grandfathers.

Satyavati slowly pinches the edge of her sari between her fingers. Her expression is calm, but her voice holds a firmness as she speaks.

PRIYA

Ancestral home! Do you know what's
happening to our son? He can't
remember anything. His body trembles,
pain in his neck... You've seen him,
haven't you? He screams at night.

Still sitting, Aarav touches his neck. His fingers brush against his throat. A look of unspoken pain flickers across his forehead.

PRIYA

What is all this happening here?
Bipin's death... the villagers'
strange looks... I'm scared, Ma. So
scared. We have to leave. Right now.

Priya presses her lips together. Her hands clutch each other over her chest.

SATYAVATI

No, daughter-in-law, we are not going
anywhere. It is our duty to serve our
family deity. Mother Durga is also
here. How can we leave her?

Satyavati looks at an old photograph of Durga on the wall.

PRIYA

Duty! What if this duty takes Aarav's life? It feels like someone is gripping him. He's lost within himself.

Aarav lifts his face. His breathing deepens. He looks at Priya. His lips are pressed shut tightly.

SATYAVATI

This place is ours. Our fathers' and grandfathers' blood is mixed in this soil. How can we run away from it? Aarav wants to prove his father innocent.

Aarav lowers his head. His fists clench even tighter. His shoulders look firm, as if he's making a decision.

PRIYA

All that is fine, but only if he stays alive first! If his mind is okay!

SATYAVATI

God always protects those who fight for the truth. Aarav is not going anywhere. God is with him.

Aarav suddenly stands up. His back is straight. He looks at Satyavati and Priya for a moment.

Then he walks to the window. A faint promise can be seen in his gaze.

Priya rubs her hands together. A shadow of helplessness crosses her face. She bows her head and sighs in despair.

Satyavati looks at Durga's photo again. A calm reflection appears on her face. She takes a deep breath.

SCENE 10

EXT. OLD KALI TEMPLE RUINS, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV

AARAV (30, troubled, in a white kurta) stands near the vine-covered wall of an old Kali temple.

The temple's broken doorway is choked with wild creepers.

Shadows from the trees stretch everywhere. Dry leaves have long since fallen on the parched earth.

Each gust of wind rustles the dry leaves with a harsh sound. It's a sound that instills fear.

AARAV glances inside the temple. It's half dark.

A chill runs through him. As if something from inside the temple reached out and touched him.

He clutches his hands to his chest. An unknown fear envelops him.

AARAV steps through the doorway. He can barely breathe.

The sound of his footsteps shatters the temple's silence.

The walls are covered in moss, and damp earth drips from the ceiling. A strange odor emanates from the idol's pedestal.

Only streaks of dusty light occasionally fall through the broken window.

AARAV slowly approaches the idol's platform.

His eyes fall directly on the idol of Mother Kali. The head is there, but the face looks terrifying. The eye sockets are empty.

The empty sockets seem to bore into him.

AARAV turns pale.

He reaches out his hand. It feels pulled by an invisible force.

His fingertips touch the cold, rough stone near the empty eye sockets.

Instantly, a powerful cold shiver runs through him, from his body to his head.

A faint humming sound reaches his ears, which after a moment turns into a sharp noise.

FLASH - AARAV'S POV: Flashes of a shattering form. Vague black shadows dance before his eyes. Glimmers of red in the darkness. It felt like a hand was gripping his neck.

AARAV's eyelids flutter shut. His head jerks back.

He grabs his neck with his left hand. He struggles to breathe.

He tastes metal in his mouth. He shakes his head and swallows.

His body begins to tremble. An overwhelming fear grips him.

He stumbles backward. His legs buckle, unable to keep pace.

His head spins. Everything around him seems to whirl.

He clenches his fists and slides down, leaning against the cold temple wall.

His eyes are open, but he sees nothing but black darkness.

After a long while, he slowly opens his eyes. A few dust motes dance in the air, drifting through the broken temple window.

His body is drenched in sweat. Breathing becomes slightly easier.

He looks again towards the idol. This time, fear is mixed with a strange question on his face.

What was all that? Why did it happen?

The fingers of his clenched fist slowly unfurl. A cold sensation in

his palm.

He places his hand on his chest. His heart pounds wildly within.

AARAV pushes himself up slowly, using the wall for support. His legs are weak.

He looks at the idol again. A sign of an unknown power in his eyes.

He steps forward, intending to leave the temple.

He stops again at the temple doorway. He turns back for one last look inside.

Deep thought on his face. An inexplicable connection had formed with this place.

He slowly rubs his neck, as if something is still pressing there.

He sinks onto a stone near the doorway, panting. His head throbs.

He rests his clenched fists on his knees and lowers his head. His fear is now turning into a resolve.

SCENE 11

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA

AARAV paces the room, sweat beading on his forehead. He keeps rubbing his neck.

His eyes dart around. His lips tremble slightly.

PRIYA sits quietly in a corner of the bed. Her hands are clenched into fists. She watches AARAV.

PRIYA presses her lips together. Tears well up in her eyes.

PRIYA

What's happening to you, Aarav? How long is this going to go on? Come on... let's get out of here. Now.

AARAV shakes his head. His pacing stops. His gaze lands on an old table in the corner of the room.

On the table is an old photo of his father. The colors have faded.

AARAV slowly walks over to the photo. His hand trembles. He picks it up.

AARAV stares at his father's smiling face in the photo. His breathing steadies a little.

AARAV

How can I leave, Priya? The stain on my father's name... how can I just leave it like this?

PRIYA

What are you going to do? You're not even well yourself! Remember that day... how your body was shaking...

AARAV places a hand on his chest. His lips tighten. His eyes stare straight ahead.

AARAV

I'll be fine. Everything started right here. Bipin's death... the mystery of the temple...

He gently places his father's photo down. He lifts his head. He looks at PRIYA.

AARAV

I want to know the truth. My father was innocent. Who stole the Kali idol, and why... I'll find out.

AARAV's voice is firm. PRIYA stares at him. Her lips part, but no sound comes out.

PRIYA

This is all too dangerous. The villagers are turning their backs on us... You don't know...

AARAV

I know. I know everything. But I can't just sit by in silence anymore.

AARAV turns to face the window. His gaze drifts to the distant temple. His eyes are steady and unwavering.

AARAV

Mother is there. She'll show me the way.

PRIYA's face goes pale. She tries to say something, but no words come out.

EPISODE 3: FALLING PREY

SCENE 1

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA, SATYAVATI

AARAV (30, deep lines of worry etched on his face) sits on an old bamboo cot. A flash of anger glints in his eyes.

PRIYA (28, in a simple saree) stands by the cot. Worry is evident on her face.

AARAV fumbles with a stack of old temple documents in his hands.

PRIYA

Aarav, why are you so worried? What happened?

AARAV speaks without looking up from the papers. There's bitterness in his voice.

AARAV

I know. This is all Bhuvon's doing. He's doing all this to frame my father.

PRIYA

But why would Bhuvon do this? What's in it for him?

SATYAVATI (60, in a white saree, the village matriarch) emerges from the kitchen. She holds a glass of water.

She walks over and stands next to AARAV.

SATYAVATI

Priya is right, son. Getting angry like this won't solve anything. Calm down.

AARAV

Auntie, didn't you hear what he said that day? How proudly Bhuvon walked around? What was he saying?

SATYAVATI offers AARAV the glass of water. AARAV doesn't take it, looking at her instead.

SATYAVATI

(ଧୀର ସ୍ବରରେ)
Yes, dear, I heard him. He was saying that Bipin wanted to remove him from the temple land and rare artifact deal. [parenthetical: softly]

AARAV nods. His face hardens. [parenthetical: with disgust]

AARAV

Exactly. He framed my father. This is all his game.

PRIYA

But Aarav, how can you proceed on mere assumptions? Until we have some proof...

AARAV cuts PRIYA off mid-sentence.

AARAV

Proof! I don't need any more proof. I've seen it all with my own eyes, heard it with my own ears. I will expose all his dirty tricks.

He slams the papers in his hand onto the cot. The documents scatter everywhere.

SATYAVATI

It's all in the hands of Goddess Kali.

AARAV clenches his fist tightly. Determination is clear on his face.

PRIYA's words falter. She stares in silence, worry etched on her face.

SCENE 2

EXT. RAMBHADIPUR VILLAGE PATH - DAY

Characters: AARAV, GURUJI

AARAV (30) walks quickly through the village square. Worry is etched on his face. His eyes scan his surroundings, glancing around repeatedly.

GURUJI (75, wearing a white turban and a simple lungi and vest) sits at the base of an old banyan tree, cutting betel nuts. His gaze is fixed on AARAV. His face is serene.

GURUJI

Hey son, where are you rushing off to in such a hurry?

AARAV stops. He looks up at GURUJI, annoyance clouding his face.

AARAV

No... nothing, Babaji. Just thinking about something.

GURUJI

Come, sit here.

GURUJI gestures to a stone near him. AARAV reluctantly moves closer and sits. He sits up straight.

GURUJI

You know, son, there's a saying. Even if the surface of a river looks calm, a strong current flows beneath.

AARAV frowns, looking at GURUJI. His eyes are questioning.

GURUJI

Our village is the same way. What you see isn't always the truth.

AARAV

What are you talking about, Babaji?

GURUJI stops cutting betel nuts. He scratches the dirt with his finger.

GURUJI

It's about Maa Kali's temple. Specifically, the goddess's precious eyes. They aren't just stone or metal.

AARAV looks at GURUJI in surprise. He leans forward slightly.

GURUJI

It's said they were protected not just by locks and keys, but by spiritual power.

AARAV

Spiritual power? When was all this?

GURUJI lets out a long sigh. His eyes seem to hold many old memories.

GURUJI

A very long time ago. Your father was a good priest, but even he didn't know everything. Not everyone can know everything.

AARAV's face hardens. His fists clench. He looks down.

GURUJI

Take my advice, don't make any hasty decisions. In a village, it's hard to know who's good and who's bad so quickly. Dig too deep, and a lot of unwanted things can surface.

AARAV nods, his face resolute. He looks at GURUJI for a moment, then unclenches his fists.

AARAV

I understand, Babaji. Thank you.

AARAV suddenly gets up. He walks away quickly, doubt still lingering in his eyes.

GURUJI watches AARAV go. He shakes his head. The lines of worry on his face deepen.

SCENE 3

EXT. ABANDONED STONE QUARRY, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, BHUBAN, MAHANTA³ 2'»

Dusty village road. AARAV (30s, an investigator lost in thought, wearing simple shirt and pants) walks, eyes fixed on the ground.

An olive green SUV is stuck in the dirt road. BHUBAN (45, frail, worried face, wearing an old, dirty kurta) stands nearby.

BHUBAN turns his left hand, heading towards the old stone quarry. AARAV notices and slows his pace.

A muffled shout from inside reaches AARAV's ears. He stops. The sound becomes clearer.

AARAV hides himself behind a large, brown rock. His eyes remain fixed on the quarry.

Inside the quarry, MAHANTA's man (35, powerfully built, stern gaze, black shirt and pants) stands before BHUBAN.

MAHANTA's man grabs BHUBAN's shoulder. BHUBAN struggles to break free.

BHUBAN

Let go of me! I have nothing else to give your Mahantha! Tell him that.

MAHANTA³ 2'»

We know that, BHUBAN. But we need to inform Mahantha Babu about what you *don't* have.

MAHANTA's man shoves BHUBAN hard. BHUBAN stumbles back, narrowly avoiding a fall.

BHUBAN

How many times do I have to say it? I don't have the temple map! I know nothing about any secret chamber.

AARAV peeks out from behind the rock. His eyes widen. Every word they speak echoes in his ears.

MAHANTA³ 2'»

That's Mahantha Babu's headache. He knows very well where you'll get the map from. And where have you hidden the old artifacts from the temple?

BHUBAN

What old artifacts? That Mahantha has gone mad over the temple's secret chamber. He's trying to frame me. He's already taken everything I had!

MAHANTA's man smiles menacingly and takes two steps towards BHUBAN.

MAHANTA³ 2'»

That's all his own stuff. But Mahantha Babu said, if the map isn't found, you'll be in trouble this time.

BHUBAN

Trouble? For what? Is he going to frame me for the idols and jewelry he himself had stolen?

AARAV gasps. His body shivers. He closes his eyes, then opens them again. He can't believe what he's hearing.

MAHANTA³ 2'»

Think carefully about what you're saying. Crossing Mahantha Babu won't do you any good.

BHUBAN clenches his fist, raising it towards MAHANTA's man. Suddenly, his anger vanishes. His body slumps, helplessness clear in his eyes.

BHUBAN

Go away! I can't say anything more.

MAHANTA's man shoves BHUBAN again, laughing cruelly.

MAHANTA³ 2'»

We have to go. But Mahantha Babu said you won't have peace for long. You'll hear some new news very soon.

MAHANTA's man struts away, chest puffed out. His footsteps fade into the distance.

BHUBAN collapses onto his knees on the ground. All strength has left him. He clutches his head with both hands.

AARAV doesn't emerge from his hiding spot. His gaze remains locked on BHUBAN, but his mind is racing. He shakes his head as if trying to grasp something big.

SCENE 4

EXT. ABANDONED STONE QUARRY, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, BHUBAN, MAHANTA³ 2'»

AARAV watches BHUBAN from behind the rocks.

BHUBAN sits on the ground, head down. He looks utterly drained of energy.

Suddenly, MAHANTA's man reappears at the mine entrance.

He glances back, making sure no one is watching him.

A small, silver locket glints in his hand.

MAHANTA's man slowly approaches the rock near where BHUBAN had been standing.

BHUBAN doesn't look up.

He drops the locket into a small hollow in the ground.
He lightly covers it with dirt, as if he'd just dropped something.
A small, triumphant smile flickers across his face.
He walks away quietly.
AARAV watches everything, hidden.
BHUBAN slowly gets to his feet.
He brushes dust off his shoulders.
He walks wearily towards the dirt road.
AARAV lets him go.
Once BHUBAN is completely gone, AARAV emerges from his hiding place.
He goes straight to where the locket fell.
He digs in the dirt and retrieves the locket.
AARAV takes the locket in his hand, turning it over.
FLASH - AARAV'S POV: BHUBAN's terrified face.

BHUBAN

BHUBAN
How many times do I have to tell you,
I don't have the temple map!

AARAV clutches the locket. For a moment, his face shows conflict.

MAHANTA³ 2'» (ECHOING)

MAN OF MAHANTA
And where did you hide the temple's
other artifacts?

AARAV's face hardens. Anger flashes in his eyes. He puts the locket in his pocket.

SCENE 5

EXT. ABANDONED STONE QUARRY, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

The night's darkness deepens the mine's atmosphere.
A cold wind whistles through.
AARAV (30s, his shirt more disheveled than before) walks alone on the dirt road.
He clutches the silver locket he found earlier tightly in his fist.
The desire to find BHUBAN burns for revenge within him.
Suddenly, a cold current runs through his body.
The locket slips from his hand and falls to the ground. A faint

clinking sound is heard.
AARAV bends down, trying to pick it up.
But his body suddenly goes out of his control.
Everything spins inside his head.
His vision blurs, darkness closing in.
A sharp ringing sound fills his ears.
The sound grows louder and louder, overwhelming his mind.
AARAV's legs tremble.
He stumbles towards the edge of the deep mine cliff.
His eyes slowly close.
With a harsh thud, AARAV crashes to the ground.
His head strikes a rock.
After some time, AARAV slowly regains consciousness.
His body aches all over. His shirt is torn.
He shakes his head and looks around. The mine cliff is beside him.
He tries to get up, but the pain is unbearable.
He can't remember anything. How he fell here.
He rubs his hands and slowly leans against the rock.

SCENE 6

INT. RAMBHADIPUR VILLAGE COUNCIL HALL - DAY

Characters: MAHANT, INSPECTOR BIJAY, CONSTABLE, VILLAGER 1, VILLAGER 2, VILLAGER 3

Inside the village Panchayat house, a crowd of people are gathered. They are frozen in fear.

In the center, PRATAP (45, wearing a torn old dhoti and vest) lies face down. Blood streams from his body.

His right hand is clenched tightly around a silver locket.

Standing a short distance away is MAHANTA (60, in a white silk Punjabi, a calm expression on his face).

A faint smile plays on his lips.

A police van arrives, sirens wailing, and stops outside.

Inspector BIJAY (40, in police uniform) and two constables enter.

Seeing the crowd, Inspector BIJAY looks annoyed.

INSPECTOR BIJAY

What happened here? Why are so many people gathered?

VILLAGER 1

Sir... Pratap is dead. Someone killed him!

The Inspector walks over to Pratap's body.

He carefully examines the locket in the dead man's hand.

INSPECTOR BIJAY

(କନେଷ୍ଟବଲ ଆଡ଼କୁ ଚାହିଁ)

Take photos. Inform the higher-ups.
[parenthetical: glancing at a constable]

VILLAGER 2

This isn't a normal death, sir. This is the wrath of the Goddess!

VILLAGER 3

Yes, that's how things have been since the beginning. He blamed the priest father...

Inspector BIJAY glares angrily at the villagers.

INSPECTOR BIJAY

Stop this nonsense! There are no goddesses, ghosts, or spirits. This is a murder.

MAHANTA watches everything silently, a look of satisfaction on his face.

INSPECTOR BIJAY

(କନେଷ୍ଟବଲକୁ)

Who were Pratap's enemies? Was there any prior dispute? Start searching.
[parenthetical: to a constable]

A constable questions a villager.

The Inspector speaks to someone on his phone.

MAHANTA slowly moves away from the crowd, that same faint smile on his lips.

SCENE 7

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, VILLAGER 1, VILLAGER 2

AARAV (30, lies on the floor, his face pale) rolls over on the floor. A low, pained groan escapes his lips.

He tries to open his eyes. Pain contorts his face. Something is swirling inside his head.

Slowly, he sits up. Rubs his head with his hands. Looks around, as if trying to recall something.

His hand touches something on the ground. A silver locket gleams there, engraved with the image of Goddess Kali.

AARAV picks up the locket. Turns it over in his hands.

FLASH - AARAV'S POV: In the desolate stone quarry, BHUBAN looks worried, the same kind of locket in his hand.

A flicker of unease crosses AARAV's face. The fragmented events of last night flash through his mind.

The faint sounds of village chatter drift in from outside, reaching his ears. He stands up.

With restless steps, he moves towards the door. Peeking through the crack in the door, he looks outside. Two women, VILLAGER 1 (50, head covered) and VILLAGER 2 (45, looks busy), are talking in the courtyard.

VILLAGER 1

Oh dear, I don't know how Pratap died.
The police can't figure it out either.

VILLAGER 2

And that silver Kali locket on his
hand! Everyone says that belonged to
BHUBAN.

AARAV's hand clenches into a fist. His gaze fixes on the silver locket. A thousand questions flood his mind.

VILLAGER 1

He framed that priest before, didn't
he? This must be his doing too.

VILLAGER 2

Didn't you see that day? How he lied
at the village council. That
scoundrel, no matter how much you say,
it's not enough. Looking at his face
just makes me angry.

AARAV's jaw tightens. Anger and worry war on his face.

VILLAGER 1

He was talking about some land, about
temple theft. It all comes back to me
now. PRATAP probably knew about it.

VILLAGER 2

Yes, I think so too. Did PRATAP
threaten him about something? Is that
why he got him out of the way?

AARAV's fist tightens even more. His nails dig into his palm.
Everything BHUBAN said now seems like a lie.

VILLAGER 1

This has never happened in this
village before. Isn't this the wrath

of the Goddess?

AARAV steps back from the door. A cold resolve settles within him.

VILLAGER 2

The police came, what could they do?
When money talks, who listens to the
plight of the poor?

VILLAGER 1

That silver Kali locket... it has a
deeper secret. That's why even the
Mahant was looking for it.

AARAV grips the locket tightly. All the confusion around him takes a definitive shape.

VILLAGER 2

BHUBAN is very clever. He'll never get
caught. I suspected him from the
moment he started talking about the
temple land.

AARAV quietly closes the door. His anger has now transformed into a firm decision.

He looks around the room. His eyes now have a single focus.

He clenches his fist around the locket. His breathing deepens.

SCENE 8

INT. MAHANTA'S HAVELI - NIGHT

Characters: MAHANTA, HENCHMAN

Inside the Mahanta's grand hall, dimly lit. The walls are adorned with old paintings of gods and goddesses. Incense burns in a corner.

The Mahanta, dressed as a sadhu in white robes, sits in a large armchair, a rudraksha mala in his hand. His face is serene.

Beside him, a short distance away, stands his henchman (40, sturdy build, dressed in black).

MAHANTA

Everything has happened just as I
wanted.

The henchman nods.

MAHANTA

Arab is completely trapped now. His
rage, his father's revenge... it's all
working for us.

HENCHMAN

After Pratap died, the villagers are
looking to Arab. They think he'll tell
the truth.

MAHANTA

(ପାଣି ପିଇଲା)

What truth will he tell? We've shown him the truth. He sees what we want him to see.

A proud smile plays on the Mahanta's lips.

HENCHMAN

So what about Bhuvan?

MAHANTA

Bhuvan? He's just a pawn. His work isn't done yet.

The henchman touches his head, utterly confused.

MAHANTA

We'll draw Arab even deeper in. This game has just begun.

HENCHMAN

And then?

MAHANTA

Then? Then the Mother's blessings. This temple, this power, this village... it will all be mine.

The Mahanta slowly rises from his chair. He picks up an old book that lay at his feet.

Its cover bears a painting of Kali.

MAHANTA

We've set him on a path from which there's no return.

He looks at the henchman, a glint of conspiracy in his eyes.

MAHANTA

Be ready for the next phase.

The henchman bows his head in agreement. The Mahanta clutches the book to his chest and walks out.

Behind him, the hall is once again swallowed by darkness.

SCENE 9

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

AARAV (28, in an old, loose kurta, looking distraught) paces his old room.

His lips tremble slightly as he hums something unintelligible.

His fingers grip each other tightly.

The dim light of an earthen lamp casts his long shadow on the wall.

AARAV

Father... whoever killed you, whoever
killed Pratap... I'll find them. I
won't let them go this time.

His voice is choked with unshed anger.

Suddenly, a gust of cold wind blows into the room through the window.

The flame of the earthen lamp flickers out. Darkness engulfs the room.

Aarav shivers. Goosebumps rise on his skin.

He feels a jolt, as if something is rising from beneath his feet.

A low, deep hum fills his ears. Like someone calling from very far away.

Aarav leans against the wall, fear etched on his face.

His breathing quickens. Veins in his neck bulge.

His muscles involuntarily tense, as if something powerful is awakening within him.

The sound stops abruptly. The trembling in his body subsides in the darkness.

Aarav slowly pulls away from the wall.

The fear on his face melts away, replaced by a strange calm and strength.

His breathing deepens, becoming steady.

Aarav clenches his fists, his nails digging deep into his palms.

He lifts his head, his gaze piercing the darkness.

He walks towards the door, each step firm with resolve.

SCENE 10

EXT. RAMBHADIPUR VILLAGE PATH - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

AARAV stepped out of his front door.

The night had completely fallen.

A faint glimmer of light was visible from a distant village.

There was no moon in the sky, and the road was pitch black.

His feet landed firmly on the ground.

AARAV's face was calm and steady.

He walked down the village path.

No sounds came from the houses.
The wind rustled the dry leaves.
Crickets chirped from the bushes.
A jackal howled in the distance.
AARAV kept walking.
He reached the end of the village.
The road ahead looked darker and more overgrown.
Thorny bushes by the roadside stood like dark shadows.
AARAV looked up and scanned his surroundings.
His gaze returned to the path.
His eyes fell on the base of an old banyan tree, where a new,
unfamiliar symbol had been carved.
AARAV stopped, examining the symbol.
His face showed a question.
He then moved forward, but his steps were hesitant.
The sound of each of his footsteps echoed clearly on the ground.
A faint sound drifted from the distant hills.
AARAV pressed on. His pace was unflagging.
AARAV's hands clenched into fists.
His breathing was deep and steady.
He passed through the thick leaves of a large tree.
His shadow stretched long before him.
AARAV continued down the dark path.

EPISODE 4: THE WRONG PATH

SCENE 1

INT. VILLAGE TEASTALL, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, KAKA, BHAI

AARAV (28, dressed in city clothes, a flicker of unease in his eyes) enters the old village tea shop. He sits in an empty chair in the back corner, looking around.

Two villagers – KAKA (50, in a white dhoti-kurta, a gamcha on his head, a habitual gossip) and BHAI (40, in simple clothes, a bit quiet) – sit at a front table, drinking tea and talking.

Their conversation drifts to AARAV. He pretends to read a newspaper, but angles himself to listen to them.

KAKA

KAKA: (To BHAI) Heard that, Bhai? This clever man is going to ruin the village.

BHAI

BHAI: What happened? Why do you say that?

KAKA

KAKA: What else? That Bhuban fellow is talking about changing the land classification near the temple. Selling it to big companies. Who knows how much money he'll make.

AARAV's hand clenches into a fist. His fingers go white against the teacup.

BHAI

BHAI: Temple land? But that land belonged to the temple! How can its classification be changed?

KAKA

KAKA: Just like his father planned to sell off Kali Maa's eyes! He's the son of that same father! They killed our poor priest over that very thing.

AARAV's face flushes with anger. His eyes blaze.

BHAI

BHAI: Yes... Remembering that priest's father, it's hard to believe. How could he have done something like that?

KAKA

KAKA: What else? It was all Bhuban's trick. He deliberately spread that

rumor so people would forget about the
land and the priest's eyes from the
idol. We even thought the priest's
father was innocent.

AARAV doesn't take any more tea. He throws the newspaper onto the
table and abruptly stands up.

There is no more doubt in his mind. BHUBAN is the culprit. He is the
root of all the conspiracy.

AARAV walks out of the shop without a word, leaving the two villagers
talking behind him.

SCENE 2

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, PRIYA

AARAV (28, sits on the prayer room floor, rifling through his
father's old books. There's a strange intensity in his eyes) sits by
the old chest in the prayer room.

His finger stops on a black book. Its corners are torn.

AARAV's breath hitches.

SATYAVATI (55, enters from the backyard, wearing a white sari, her
face etched with worry) stands in the doorway, watching AARAV.

SATYAVATI frowns.

SATYAVATI

What is it, son... what are you
looking for? How much longer will you
dig up all the old stories?

AARAV doesn't look up from the book.

AARAV

My father's things, Ma. This book had
so much written in it.

SATYAVATI

Your father is gone. Let him rest in
peace. And you stop being so stubborn.

AARAV slams the book shut in anger. The scent of old paper fills the
air.

AARAV

How can he rest in peace, Ma? Those
who killed him, if they aren't
punished, how can he find peace?

SATYAVATI

Revenge blinds you, son. This path is
wrong. You'll only hurt yourself.

PRIYA (27, dressed in city clothes, stands at the entrance, her eyes

showing exhaustion) enters from outside and forces a tired smile.

PRIYA

(ଦୁର୍ବଳ ସ୍ବରରେ)
Ma's right, Aarav. Look at yourself...
you're so weak. (in a frail voice)

AARAV looks at PRIYA. His annoyance is evident.

AARAV

I'm fine. Why are you worrying so much?

PRIYA

You're not fine? The other night you
suddenly collapsed! Do you know how
scared I was? Don't you remember?

AARAV's eyes drift to the prayer room ceiling, as if trying to recall something.

SATYAVATI

Yes, son, this darkness is spreading
on your face... I'm scared.

SATYAVATI moves closer to AARAV and touches his cheek.

AARAV

(ରାଗରେ ହାତ ଝାଡ଼ିଦେଇ)
I'm fine, Ma. Just a little tired.
(brushing his hand away angrily)

PRIYA

This isn't just tiredness, Aarav.
Let's go back to Bhubaneswar. I have a
doctor friend. She can definitely help.

AARAV stands up.

AARAV

No! I'm not going anywhere. I won't
let go of whoever killed Father. His
spirit wanders here.

PRIYA

But how will you do it? You're falling
ill yourself.

AARAV

Nothing will happen to me. Nobody here
understands me. I know what I have to
do.

AARAV clutches the book to his chest. A strange resolve fills his eyes.

He turns his back on them and walks out of the prayer room.

PRIYA takes a deep breath. Her lips tremble.

SATYAVATI hugs PRIYA.

SCENE 3

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

Moonlight streams through the window, falling on the dusty floorboards inside. The silence of the night is broken only by the chirping of crickets.

ARAV (30, worried) sits on the bed, eyes wide with sleeplessness. Before him lies his father's thick, old book, open.

Arav's fingers trace the yellowed pages of the book.

Suddenly, a crumpled piece of paper falls from between the book's pages.

Arav's gaze fixes on the paper. He picks it up from the floor. It's covered in faded script.

Arav carefully unfolds the paper.

Scrawled within, in faint letters: 'Bhuban's hut holds a hidden treasure.'

Arav's breath catches. His fingers grip the paper.

A strange determination dawns on his face.

He immediately gets off the bed and stands.

Arav fumbles in the dark, finding and putting on his pants and shirt.

He slings his small bag, containing a flashlight and water bottle, over his shoulder.

Arav reaches the main door of the courtyard and silently grasps the doorknob.

The door creaks open with a low groan.

Outside, the darkness is thick, with no starlight. The faint sound of dogs barking from a distant village drifts in.

Arav steps outside.

He quietly closes the door, a soft click of wood echoing.

Arav merges with the path beside the fence. His footsteps disappear into the dark night.

From the shadow of the large banyan tree at the edge of the property, a dark figure detaches itself and vanishes instantly into the darkness.

SCENE 4

EXT. BHUBAN'S ISOLATED SHACK, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, HENCHMAN

Darkness swallows AARAV (30, quiet, watchful) as he approaches a hut on the edge of the village.

Dry leaves crunch underfoot. He stops, wary.

Through the thick dark, a dim light spills from the hut's window.

Thorny bushes surround the hut. The wind carries the scent of burning earth and leaves.

AARAV melts into the dense shadows of the trees. His heart pounds.

He crawls to a small hole in the wall and peers inside.

Inside the hut, the faint light of a murky lantern flickers.

In the light, a plump HENCHMAN (40, stout, furrowed brow) sits on the floor.

Papers, ledgers, and maps are scattered before him.

HENCHMAN picks up a receipt. He studies it, focused.

AARAV sees a counterfeit seal stamped on the receipt.

AARAV takes a deep breath. His lips tighten.

HENCHMAN rubs his head, frowning.

Then, he opens a brown sack beside him.

He pulls out several small, blackened figurines from the sack.

They look like old temple idols.

A sharp glint in AARAV's eyes. His nostrils flare.

HENCHMAN carefully sets the figurines aside.

He then unfolds an old, dirty map. He spreads it on the hut's dirt floor.

The map is marked with red circles around parts of the village and land.

HENCHMAN consults the map with a small notebook.

A strange look crosses his face, as if he's calculating something.

AARAV clenches his fist. His nails dig into his palm.

HENCHMAN seems weary. He lets out a long sigh.

He puts the papers and figurines back into the sack.

A small, half-burnt piece of paper slips from his hand and falls to the floor.

HENCHMAN doesn't notice. He's absorbed in his work.

AARAV's gaze fixes on the paper.
He can see some half-written words on it.
AARAV cautiously emerges from the tree's shadow.
He stands by the hut's window. His heart races.

HENCHMAN

HENCHMAN: How much longer will this
take...

HENCHMAN turns, weariness in his eyes.

HENCHMAN

HENCHMAN: Even Bhuvan won't leave me
in peace. I'm doing all this.

HENCHMAN begins counting some money from a pouch, his face etched
with fatigue.

A determined look on AARAV's face. His breathing quickens.
He moves away from the window and goes to the hut's door.

SCENE 5

INT. BHUBAN'S ISOLATED SHACK, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, HENCHMAN

AARAV burst through the door.

The door creaked open.

Inside, a HENCHMAN (40s, heavysset, annoyed) jumped, startled.

Money spilled from his hands onto the floor.

He looked at AARAV, terrified.

AARAV's eyes flashed with anger.

His lips tightened.

AARAV

What are you doing here? You killed my
father, and now you're sitting here
with all these fake papers?

HENCHMAN

What are you talking about? Whose
father? What fake papers? Get out of
here. You won't like what happens if
you don't.

AARAV gestured to the fake receipts and old idols scattered on the
floor.

AARAV

Still lying? Trying to seize the
temple's land with all these tricks?

Did you think no one would find out
after you killed my father?

The HENCHMAN's face flushed red.

He angrily grabbed a heavy piece of wood from the floor.

HENCHMAN

You're talking too big! I'm nobody.
I'm just doing what Mr. Bhuvan told me
to do!

AARAV couldn't take any more.

He lunged and grabbed the HENCHMAN by the collar.

The HENCHMAN was shocked.

He threw down the piece of wood and shoved AARAV.

They grappled.

Things flew around the room.

An old clay table tipped over.

A lantern hanging above it swayed.

AARAV's face contorted in pain.

His grip on the HENCHMAN's collar tightened.

The HENCHMAN struggled to breathe.

His face turned red.

The flash in AARAV's eyes changed.

The lantern light flared, then dimmed.

AARAV's body began to tremble strangely.

His breathing grew heavy.

The HENCHMAN stared at AARAV's changed eyes, terrified.

He backed away.

AARAV released his grip.

He clutched his head with both hands.

His body shook violently.

The lantern flame swayed wildly. A faint scratching sound came from
the glass of the small window on the wall.

A garbled, horrific scream tore from AARAV's throat.

Then he collapsed.

Silence all around.

The lantern light burned dimly.

The HENCHMAN backed away in fear. He stared at AARAV, terrified.

SCENE 6

INT. BHUBAN'S ISOLATED SHACK, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

AARAV slowly opens his eyes.

His head felt heavy. The air was thick with smoke.

He coughed. His eyes began to sting.

He painfully rolled to the side in the ashes.

The sharp smell of burnt wood and ash hung in the air.

The heat from the flickering flames hit his face.

He pushed himself up slightly, leaning on his elbow.

His whole body ached. His head throbbed.

Leaning on his left arm, he painfully stood up.

He looked at the remains of the hut.

The walls were blackened. More than half the roof had collapsed.

Burnt wooden posts and bamboo lay scattered, reduced to ash.

Where did HENCHMAN go? AARAV looked around, searching.

The place was empty. No one was in the hut.

His gaze fell on some papers lying on the ground.

He bent down and picked up a paper from the ashes.

The corner of the receipt was burnt and torn. He recognized it - that forged receipt.

Holding the forged documents, he sank into thought.

His hand touched something in the ashes.

He slowly brushed away the ashes with his hand.

An old, half-burnt palm-leaf manuscript. It was wedged between charred wood.

He carefully picked up the manuscript. Ashes clung to his hand.

He held it and stared, surprised, for a moment.

He gently opened the palm-leaf manuscript.

The letters were burnt in many places, but some were still readable.

AARAV read intently. His lips moved slightly.

He read - 'Kali Puja Ritual'... 'Secret Chamber'... 'Temple Foundation'.

Something lit up in his eyes. Like a new mystery was unfolding.
He clutched the manuscript to his chest. His lips set firmly.
AARAV looked around again. His gaze sharpened.

SCENE 7

EXT. RAMBHADIPUR VILLAGE PATH - DAY

Characters: AARAV, ±{>° 2'» ¶rÂ ³ë ³+K±R h, ±{>° 2'» ¶•

AARAV walked down the village road, leaving the burnt remains of the hut behind him.

Ash clung to his clothes, exhaustion etched on his face.

The air carried a mixed scent of cow dung and burnt wood.

A distant commotion reached his ears. Shouts.

AARAV looked up, towards the sound.

Suddenly, two villagers sprinted past him, eyes wide with fear.

±{>° 2'» ¶p
Hey, hurry up! The Sarpanch's house is
on fire!

AARAV stopped, watching them go.

±{>° 2'» ¶€
I heard it's completely burnt to ashes!

More people hurried down the same path.

±{>° 2'» ¶•
Did they find the old Sarpanch's body
too? Burnt to a crisp!

Those words hit AARAV. He froze.

Disbelief in his eyes. One hand slowly rose to his left ear.

He turned, looking back towards the fire.

A thick column of smoke rose into the distant sky.

He clutched the book in his hand. His expression changed.

A deep worry clouded his eyes. After a moment, he started walking again. This time, with more resolve.

SCENE 8

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI

AARAV (30s, in a white pajama-kurta) spreads a pile of papers on a wooden plank, examining them. Beside him lies a half-burnt book.

He traces some letters on the burnt book with his left thumb. Dust from the ashes falls off.

His gaze settles on a peculiar drawing inside the book, depicting the foundation of a temple.

His lips tighten. His expression suggests he's made a significant decision.

SATYAVATI (70s, in a white sari) enters the room with slow, silent steps.

She stands quietly behind AARAV, watching him.

SATYAVATI

It's late, Aarav. How many more nights will you stay awake like this, my son?

Startled, AARAV spins around abruptly.

AARAV

Mother! I thought you were asleep.

SATYAVATI

How can I sleep when I see such worry on your face?

SATYAVATI sits down on a wooden chair nearby.

AARAV

I've found all the proof, Mother. Bhuvan is the one who murdered Father. He's responsible for all of this.

He picks up some of the papers, revealing forged receipts and maps.

SATYAVATI

Not everything written on paper is the truth, son. Sometimes, people get caught in a much bigger web.

AARAV

A web? You're right, Mother. That web was woven by Bhuvan, not me. I'm going to the temple today. Everything will come to light.

He tucks the burnt book into his pocket. A fierce glint in his eyes.

SATYAVATI

Yesterday, the Sarpanch's house caught fire. We still don't know how he died. This isn't coincidence, Aarav. Stay away from this.

AARAV

It's their karma, Mother. Mother Kali herself is delivering their justice. Now, I will expose all these false faces.

AARAV, holding the papers, walks towards the door.

SATYAVATI

Do you truly know what you're doing,
son? This village, this temple, our
family... they all have an old story,
one you've forgotten.

AARAV

I remember it all, Mother. That's
exactly why I'm going. Father will get
justice.

AARAV opens the door and walks out.

SATYAVATI lets out a deep sigh, deep worry etched on her face. She
remains seated, silent.

SCENE 9

EXT. RAMBHADIPUR VILLAGE OUTSKIRTS - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

AARAV, a man in his thirties, is dressed in a white pajama-kurta. He
walks down a dusty road outside the village of Rambhadipur.

The darkness of night has enveloped everything. The moon casts a
faint glow in the sky.

The gentle rustling of leaves from the bushy trees lining the road
can be heard in the wind.

AARAV's footsteps fall on the ground with a steady, measured rhythm.

His eyes scan the darkness, as if searching for something.

He pulled a folded piece of paper from his jeans pocket.

He touched it in the darkness.

For a moment, he stared intently at it.

Then, he put it back in his pocket.

Two shadowy figures emerged from behind the clump of bamboo trees by
the roadside.

They had been lurking in the cover of darkness.

Their sharp eyes were fixed on AARAV.

They followed AARAV, their steps silent, moving slowly.

AARAV passed by an old, massive banyan tree.

Its thick branches hung low over the road.

Nothing could be heard but the sound of the wind whistling through
the dense foliage of the tree.

The shadowy figures concealed themselves in the deep shade of the

banyan tree.

One of them signaled to the other with his eyes.

AARAV turned a bend in the road.

Now, in the distance, the broken spire of the Kali temple was more clearly visible.

AARAV's pace quickened. He moved towards the temple.

The two shadowy figures exchanged glances.

A slow, enigmatic smile played on one of their lips.

One gestured with his hand, signaling the other to move to the opposite side of the road.

They stealthily followed AARAV, keeping to opposite sides of the road.

AARAV reached the old wall of the temple.

A deep silence reigned all around, broken only by the chirping of crickets.

He took a deep breath and looked towards the main entrance of the temple.

His face showed firm resolve, not a trace of doubt.

SCENE 10

EXT. OLD KALI TEMPLE RUINS, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, HENCHMAN 1, HENCHMAN 2

AARAV reaches the crumbling wall of the old Kali temple.

In the dim moonlight, cracks and fragments of broken idols are visible on the temple walls.

The two massive stone pillars by the temple gate hang half-broken.

With every gust of wind, dry leaves scrape across the ground, a slow, mournful sound.

AARAV slowly climbs the steps and steps inside the temple.

His shoes crunch on the dry, brittle leaves.

He pulls out the burnt old manuscript from his pocket. Tries to read it in the moonlight.

His eyes scan the interior of the temple carefully, especially towards the foundation.

A bat flies from somewhere and passes over his head.

AARAV is startled, but quickly regains composure.

He moves forward and reaches the main hall.

The pedestal, missing its idol, appears even darker from the entrance.

Loose soil crunches under his feet.

Suddenly, a thick rope hanging from the temple falls like a noose, brushing his feet.

AARAV looks up.

A look of confusion crosses his face.

HENCHMAN 1, a stern-faced 35-year-old in a thick safari shirt, emerges from behind an old temple pillar.

Behind him stands HENCHMAN 2, a 40-year-old with sharp eyes, a gamcha tied around his head, holding the other end of the rope.

HENCHMAN 1

So, you finally made it? We've been waiting for you, pal.

AARAV glances at the rope, then at the HENCHMEN.

AARAV

Who are you? What do you want from me?

HENCHMAN 2

What else would we want? We've come to settle the score for what you stole.

A look of fierce anger is evident on AARAV's face.

HENCHMAN 1 throws the rope he's holding towards AARAV.

AARAV instinctively lunges back, narrowly dodging it as the rope whizzes past him.

He draws the small dagger he had hidden in his pajamas.

The dagger's blade glints in the moonlight.

AARAV

I'm no thief. You think you can scare me in Mother Kali's temple?

HENCHMAN 2

Mother Kali isn't here. Only death resides here.

The dagger tightens in AARAV's grip.

His eyes are steady and intense, locked on the enemy.

EPISODE 5: MOTHER'S TERROR

SCENE 1

EXT. OLD KALI TEMPLE RUINS, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, BHUBAN

Night's darkness cloaks the crumbling walls of the old Kali temple.

Deep silence all around. Only the sound of the night wind whistles through the window.

Faint moonlight filters through cracks in the wall, falling on the dusty ground.

AARAV (28, dusty black pants and white shirt, wet hair, stern expression) enters with the rustling sound of dry leaves.

His breathing is rapid. He scans his surroundings sharply.

In a corner, BHUBAN (45, dirty dhoti and gamcha, thin frame, eyes wide with fear) huddles against the wall, shrinking.

His face is buried low. Hearing AARAV's footsteps, he looks up.

AARAV

BHUBAN! What are you doing here?

Bhuban jumps, flailing. Seeing Aarav, the color drains from his face.

BHUBAN

(ଡରି ଡରି)

A... Babu Aarav! You... since when?
(trembling)

AARAV

Since when? Forget that.

Aarav advances towards him, his footsteps echoing in the dark temple.

AARAV

Why didn't you tell me the truth?
What's going on in the village?

BHUBAN

(କାନ୍ଦୁ ଆସୁଛି କାନ୍ଦୁଛି ଧରି)

I... I'm not involved, sir. Believe me. I'm innocent. (clutching the wall tighter)

AARAV

Innocent? You're saying you had no hand in what's happening in the village? No role in their deaths?

Tears begin to stream down Bhuban's face. His body trembles.

BHUBAN

No, sir! How could I do something like

that? For the past two nights, I was at the Shitaleshwar temple.

BHUBAN

I had made a vow for my elder brother's health. I didn't move from there for a single minute.

AARAV

At Shitaleshwar temple? So many people are there, who saw you?

BHUBAN

The priest is there. And three or four other devotees were with me all night, singing hymns.

BHUBAN

You can inquire. They will all vouch for me.

Aarav frowns. His gaze fixes on Bhuban's tear-filled eyes.

AARAV

(ଧୀର ସ୍ବରରେ)
Are you telling the truth? (in a low voice)

BHUBAN

I am telling the truth, sir. I'm not the kind of person to do such things. Whatever I did, I did on the Mahant's word... out of fear.

The moment he heard the name 'Mahant', Aarav's expression changed. His eyes sharpened.

He takes another step closer. Bhuban shrinks further.

AARAV

The Mahant? What did the Mahant say?

BHUBAN

Years ago... he threatened me. Said he would kill my family.

BHUBAN

That's why I spread lies. Against your father... I created false rumors.

Aarav's eyes widen. His lips tremble.

His face seems to lose all color.

AARAV

What? Against my father... What rumors?

BHUBAN

(କାହିଁ କାହିଁ)
That your father stole from the

temple's eye... and I also changed the temple's land records. (crying)

BHUBAN

It was all... all lies, sir. I did it all on the Mahant's word.

Bhuban bangs his head against the wall. His shoulders shake uncontrollably.

Aarav stands there, stunned. His fists clench.

He tries to compose himself, but his gaze pierces through Bhuban.

SCENE 2

EXT. OLD KALI TEMPLE RUINS, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, BHUBAN

Aarav breathed deeply. He lifted his gaze from Bhuban, staring at the dark wall of the ruined temple.

Bhuban's last words echoed in his head.

AARAV

Mahant... what else did he make you do? Did you lie about anything else?

Bhuban flinched, his eyes closing. He shook his head, denying it.

BHUBAN

No, sir... I haven't lied about anything else. But... the Mahant is a powerful man. He has a long reach.

AARAV

Powerful? What does he have that makes him so daring?

Bhuban looked down, his face pressed against the wall. His voice trembled.

BHUBAN

He has a special vault in his house, sir. He's hidden many of the temple's treasures there.

Aarav's eyebrows shot up. A question formed in his eyes.

AARAV

What? What treasures? Those old idols?

BHUBAN

No... no, sir. Something bigger than that. The eyes of Maa Kali... the ones your father supposedly stole, which he made me say.

Aarav felt like his breath caught in his throat. He stood up straight, his fists clenching.

AARAV

Eyes? He still has them? Why?

Bhuban looked at Aarav fearfully. His mouth felt dry.

BHUBAN

He said... they were his greatest possession. Like a trophy.

Aarav's face hardened. The skin behind his ears grew hot.

BHUBAN

It's not just about wealth, sir... he did it to show his power. He's the most powerful man in the village. No one can touch him.

Aarav closed his eyes. He heard something inside him shatter.

His lips trembled. He looked at the wall, as if seeking an answer there.

Bhuban kept his head bowed. His shoulders shook.

In the dark night, a heavy silence settled over the temple, carried by the wind.

SCENE 3

EXT. OLD KALI TEMPLE RUINS, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, BHUBAN

Aarav's eyes snapped open. The anger in them had now shifted to a deep hurt.

AARAV

So... everything all these years was a lie?

He turned away, his legs trembling. He clutched at the broken temple wall.

AARAV

My father... my father was innocent.

Bhuban slowly lowered his head, regret clouding his eyes.

BHUBAN

Yes, sir... he was framed. Forgive me.

Aarav looked at Bhuban. The anger was gone from his face, replaced by the pain of accepting a terrible truth.

AARAV

Why did you stay silent for so long?

BHUBAN

(ଢ଼ରି ଢ଼ରି)

The Mahant... he has a lot of influence. He kept me scared, sir.

Threatened to kill my children.
[parenthetical: fearfully]

Aarav closed his eyes. The Mahant's name echoed in his ears like poison.

He opened his eyes again. This time, a strange resolve hardened them.

AARAV

The Mahant's house... that treasury,
those eyes...

He took two steps towards Bhuvan. His gaze swept over the ruined temple.

AARAV

My investigation is going in a new
direction now, Bhuvan. I won't let
anyone get away with it.

Bhuban trembled. The determination on Aarav's face frightened him.

BHUBAN

(ସ୍ବରାଜ୍ୟ)
Sir... the Mahant is powerful. You're
alone... [parenthetical: softly]

AARAV

(କାଟି ଦେଇ)
I'm not alone. I have my father's
revenge. I have Mother Kali's
blessings. [parenthetical: cutting him
off]

He turned towards the temple entrance. His steps were firm, without hesitation.

Aarav walked out of the temple into the dark night. Every step aimed at a new target.

Bhuban stood by a pillar of the broken temple, his eyes fixed on the path Aarav had taken.

SCENE 4

EXT. RAMBHADIPUR VILLAGE PATH - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

AARAV walks down the dark village road. His steps are heavy.

He stops, gripping the iron railing by the road. His breath is hot.

In the distance, a dog barks.

He shakes his head, as if chastising himself.

His lips tremble. A faint sound escapes his throat.

AARAV

(to himself)

What a terrible mistake I've made...

BHUVAN's terrified face flashes in his eyes. Tearful eyes, a pleading voice.

He covers his face with both hands. Squeezes his eyes shut tight.

The MAHANT's name echoes in his ears, like poison.

And with it, a flash of his father's innocent smile.

A shiver runs through him. Goosebumps prick his skin.

He slowly lowers his hands. His gaze is fixed on the empty air.

The terrifying scene from twenty years ago flashes before his eyes – the pain of losing his father.

He takes a deep breath, as if drawing all the weight in.

He lifts his head. His face, once weary, now shows determination.

His eyes hold a fierce resolve. The expression on his face is not of revenge, but of a desire to mend.

He walks forward on the road. His steps are quick now.

In the dark night, his shadow stretches long behind him.

SCENE 5

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI

Aarav enters the house. His face is pale. His eyes show fatigue and a restless gaze.

He walks slowly into the large hall. His head is bowed.

Satyavati (28, in a simple saree, a calm face) emerges from the kitchen. Seeing Aarav, a line of worry appears on her face.

SATYAVATI

What happened? Why does your face look like this?

Aarav doesn't answer. His breathing grows heavy. His body begins to tremble.

Satyavati walks slowly towards him. She reaches out to touch Aarav's shoulder.

SATYAVATI

Aarav... tell me what's wrong. I'm here...

Aarav's eyes stare blankly ahead. The muscles in his face tighten. His body stiffens, as if something is gripping him tightly from within.

A deep, guttural, unclear sound comes from his lips.

The moment Satyavati's hand touches his shoulder, Aarav's hand suddenly shoots up.

He shoves Satyavati hard. Satyavati cries out.

Satyavati is thrown backward. She hits her back hard against the wooden cupboard behind her. A dry thud.

She collapses to the floor in a heap. Her hands grip the cupboard. Tears begin to stream from her eyes.

Aarav remains standing there. His eyes are vacant. His gaze holds no emotion.

Satyavati tries to inch backward, pressing against the wall in fear. Her breath catches.

A slow tremor starts from deep within Aarav's body. His fists slowly clench.

SCENE 6

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI

AARAV's eyes are vacant. His fists are clenched. He slowly advanced toward SATYAVATI, who had stumbled backward.

SATYAVATI recoiled in terror. Her eyes were wide with the fear of death. She tried to scream as she looked at AARAV, but no sound came out.

AARAV stood before her. An unknown heat emanated from his body. His hand reached out toward SATYAVATI.

AARAV's fingers closed around SATYAVATI's neck. The pressure increased.

SATYAVATI's face turned red. Her hands flailed, trying to pry AARAV's off. Her breath caught in her throat.

Suddenly, a soft light flickered from a small Kali idol nearby. The air around it trembled for a moment.

A deafening sound echoed inside AARAV's head. As if a thousand kettle drums beat at once.

KALI MATA (V.O.)

Innocent... Protected!

Pain contorted AARAV's face. His eyes, instead of pure emotion, held confusion. His grip slowly loosened.

He suddenly released SATYAVATI. Jerking back, he stumbled two steps. He clutched his forehead with both hands.

Freed, SATYAVATI collapsed to the floor. She gasped for air, writhing on the ground. Deep marks from AARAV's fingers were on her neck.

AARAV stood unsteadily, clutching his body. His breathing was rapid.

A look of profound astonishment on his face.

SCENE 7

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI

AARAV slowly lowers his hand from his forehead. His eyes dart around vaguely, as if waking from a dream.

SATYAVATI is still curled up on the floor. Her hands instinctively go to her neck, her body trembling with fear.

AARAV's gaze falls on SATYAVATI. Seeing her pathetic state, deeper confusion clouds AARAV's face.

His eyes fix on the deep red finger marks around SATYAVATI's neck. A cold shiver runs down AARAV's spine.

He suddenly looks at his own hands. He turns them over, makes fists, then unclenches them, as if they don't belong to him.

He tries to say something, but only a strangled gasp escapes his throat.

SATYAVATI flinches at the sound. She tries to press herself further into the wall, her eyes on AARAV, filled with terror.

AARAV sees the fear in SATYAVATI's eyes. It pains him that she wants to distance herself from him.

He touches his forehead again, feeling an unfamiliar heat.

FLASH - AARAV'S POV: The image flashes in AARAV's mind: his hands gripping SATYAVATI's neck. SATYAVATI's pained face.

AARAV recoils violently from the memory. His back hits the wall. He slides down slowly, collapsing onto his knees.

His breathing quickens. His hands tremble uncontrollably. He looks at SATYAVATI again, then at his own hands.

AARAV

Satya... (gasping) Wh... What happened?

SATYAVATI gives no answer. Her fear is so profound, she can only shake her head slowly.

AARAV shifts forward slightly, as if desperate to hear something, to deny his guilt.

AARAV

(ବିଶ୍ୱାସ ନ କରି)
I... I hurt you?

SATYAVATI flinches. She slowly points to her neck with her trembling hand, then at AARAV.

Her lips part, and a soft sob escapes.

SATYAVATI

(ଧୀର କାନ୍ଦି କାନ୍ଦି)
You...

AARAV stares at her, then at his hands, then back at SATYAVATI's neck. It all becomes clear, a brutal truth.

His face drains of color. Tears well up in his eyes. A choked sound, half sob, half gasp, escapes his lips.

He clenches his fists so tight his knuckles turn white, his nails digging into his palms.

He tries to stand, but his legs give out, and he sinks back to the floor.

He looks around the room wildly, searching for an escape, an explanation. His eyes land on a small, dark statue.

He stares at the statue, then at his hands. His breath hitches, fear seizing him.

AARAV

(ସ୍ୱର ଭାଙ୍ଗିଯାଉଛି)
No... No, this can't be. I... I
couldn't have done this.

SATYAVATI watches him, still terrified, but seeing his brokenness, a flicker of pity crosses her face.

AARAV buries his face in his hands. He shakes his head violently, denying the truth. His shoulders begin to shake with quiet sobs.

He slowly lifts his head. His eyes are red and swollen. He sees his reflection in a dusty mirror on the wall.

His reflection stares back at him. But for a moment, his eyes hold an unfamiliar, deep darkness, the shadow of something else. He blinks, and the shadow is gone.

He is left to confront his terrible act and the possibility of the monster within him.

SCENE 8

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, DURGA

AARAV lies face down on the floor. His shoulders shake. Tears stream down his face.

SATYAVATI is curled up in the corner. She trembles slightly. Her eyes are vacant. The finger marks on AARAV's neck are stark.

A heavy silence fills the room. Only SATYAVATI's choked sobs can be heard.

DURGA (70, in a white silk sari, her face etched with years of sorrow) slowly approaches AARAV. She wipes her eyes.

She sees SATYAVATI. SATYAVATI lowers her head. An immense pain washes over DURGA's face.

DURGA

Aarav... my son... what I feared has happened.

AARAV slowly removes his hands from his face. His eyes hold only grief and confusion.

AARAV

Grandma... what... what have I done?
Am I going mad?

DURGA sits down on the floor beside him. She places a hand on AARAV's shoulder. Her hand trembles.

DURGA

No, my son, you are not mad. This is karma...

AARAV

(କାଳି ଭାବେଲି)
Karma? This is my sickness! Darkness
is swallowing me whole. I hurt
Satya... [parenthetical: he pulls away]

AARAV's words catch in his throat. He clutches his own fingers.

AARAV

How can I forgive myself?

SATYAVATI slowly lifts her head, looking at DURGA. Her eyes hold a question, and a flicker of fear.

DURGA

This is not darkness. This is the
curse and blessing of our priestly
lineage.

AARAV

A curse? A blessing? What does that
mean? How is this 'blackout' a curse?

DURGA brings her face close to AARAV's. Her voice deepens.

DURGA

This darkness of yours is the wrath of
Mother Kali.

DURGA

When her eyes were stolen...

SATYAVATI's fearful eyes widen. She listens to DURGA.

DURGA

Our priestly family has served Mother
for hundreds of years. Guarded her
temple.

DURGA

The day her eyes were stolen, Mother began to breathe vengeance.

AARAV

So... I... I am the instrument of Mother's vengeance?

AARAV suddenly pushes himself back. He beats his chest on the floor. His eyes blaze with defiance.

AARAV

(କାନ୍ଦି କାନ୍ଦି)

No! This cannot be true! I refuse to believe it! [parenthetical: sobbing]

DURGA shakes her head firmly. Tears roll down her cheeks. She strokes AARAV's face.

DURGA

Yes, my son. This 'blackout' is not your sickness. It is the awakening of Mother's power.

AARAV trembles. He shakes his head. His face is a mask of incomprehension.

DURGA

Mother Kali has entered you... to punish the unjust.

DURGA turns to SATYAVATI. She slowly reaches out a hand towards her.

SATYAVATI flinches back at first. Fear in her eyes.

DURGA speaks softly, stroking her head. SATYAVATI gradually rests her head on DURGA's shoulder, tears flowing.

AARAV

(କମ୍ପିତ୍ୱ ସ୍ୱରରେ)

But... I hurt Satya. She's innocent. [parenthetical: voice trembling]

DURGA releases SATYAVATI. She clasps AARAV's hands in hers.

DURGA

Mother knows everything, son. She protects the innocent.

DURGA

It was Mother's power in your hands that protected Satya. Not to harm her.

SATYAVATI slowly nods. Her fear seems to subside. A new understanding dawns in her eyes.

AARAV looks up at DURGA, his eyes red-rimmed. He sees deep conviction in her gaze.

DURGA

The souls of our ancestors are restless. It is your duty to bring back Mother's eyes.

DURGA

You are Mother's vessel. You are her vengeance.

AARAV takes a deep, shuddering breath. The terrible truth hits him. He looks up.

His eyes still hold grief and fear, but a new, strong resolve glimmers within them. He rises, very slowly.

SCENE 9

INT. AARAV'S ANCESTRAL HOME, RAMBHADIPUR - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, DURGA, SATYAVATI

AARAV (28, troubled) sits hunched on the floor, hands clenched tightly together. His body trembles slightly.

DURGA (70, a mix of worry and resolve on her face) leans towards him. Deep peace lines her features.

SATYAVATI (25, a mix of fear and awe on her face) stands a short distance away, her eyes fixed on AARAV, waiting for his every word.

AARAV

I... Maa's vessel? Will take revenge?
How is this possible?

DURGA nods slowly, her eyes welling up with tears.

DURGA

Our ancestors bore this burden before,
son. Now it is your turn.

AARAV lifts his head and looks around. His gaze stops on a small Kali idol in the corner of the room.

He takes a slow breath. The idol's eyes seem to be watching him.

He tries to stand, but his legs wobble. He puts a hand on the wall for support.

SATYAVATI instinctively reaches out to him, then quickly pulls her hand back.

DURGA

Maa's eyes must be restored, the
sanctity of the temple must be
restored.

AARAV looks at DURGA with a questioning gaze. His lips tremble.

AARAV

But I... I am an ordinary person. I
don't even know the rituals.

DURGA

When Maa chooses someone, she fills them with power. You have that power within you.

AARAV's fists clench tighter. The knuckles of his fingers turn white. His breathing deepens.

FLASH - AARAV'S POV: SATYAVATI's terrified face is before him. AARAV's hand is around her throat.

FLASH - AARAV'S POV: SATYAVATI falls to the floor.

AARAV looks at his own hands, which are still shaking.

AARAV

This power is driving me mad!

SATYAVATI

But... my aunt said... Maa protected me.

AARAV looks at SATYAVATI. Then back at DURGA. A flicker of conflict in his eyes.

DURGA

That power has two forms, son. You must learn to recognize them.

AARAV slowly draws his legs together and stands straight. His legs still tremble slightly.

His eyes fall on an old, dusty mirror hanging on the wall.

He walks slowly towards the mirror. His reflection looks faint.

He raises one hand to his forehead and presses hard. Pain shows in his eyes.

AARAV

Is this true? I am Kali's vessel?

SATYAVATI and DURGA watch him in silence. Deep hope and prayer on their faces.

AARAV moves closer to the mirror. His breath catches.

He looks into his own eyes. His dark irises appear unnaturally large.

Then, for a moment. In the depth of his reflection's eyes, a swirling black energy began to spin.

It fades again. Appears again, this time with more intensity. More concentrated.

AARAV recoils slightly. A soft sound escapes his lips.

That blazing black energy begins to grow, for a moment completely engulfing the black part of his eyes.

AARAV stares at his reflection, eyes wide. His hands slowly drop to his sides.

EPISODE 6: THE GODDESS'S VESSEL

SCENE 1

INT. AARAV'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, PRIYA

AARAV (25, gaunt, thin-bodied) is breathing heavily in the darkness of the bedroom.

His body is slick with a cold sweat. He sits up in bed.

Flickering shadows dance before his eyes.

He jolts awake at the sound of a terrifying cry.

AARAV clutches his head with both hands. His face is pale.

Drawn by AARAV's cries, SATYAVATI (45, worried face) and PRIYA (22, modern clothes, uneasy eyes) enter the room.

SATYAVATI hurries to the bedside.

SATYAVATI

What happened, Aarav? Did you wake up scared again?

SATYAVATI (CONT'D)

Why is your body so cold?

AARAV grips their hand tightly. A choked sound escapes his throat.

AARAV

Mom... Kali Maa... she's doing all this. Not me. I don't know anything.

PRIYA stands by the door. She presses her lips together.

PRIYA

Damn it, Aarav, what madness is this! Why are you dragging Mom into what you're doing yourself?

AARAV shakes his head. Tears well up in his eyes.

AARAV

I'm not acting, Priya. I'm telling the truth. I feel like she's inside me.

SATYAVATI

Hush, Priya! (To Aarav) No, no, it's nothing like that. You're feverish. Want some water? Should we see a doctor?

AARAV pulls away from SATYAVATI's hand. A strange determination in his eyes.

AARAV

How can I explain? What I'm doing...
it isn't me. She's sitting inside me,
doing everything.

PRIYA takes a step forward. Accusation on her face.

PRIYA

I knew you'd act like this. What will
the villagers say about us again?

PRIYA (CONT'D)

We lost our father... are we going to
lose ourselves now?

AARAV stares intensely at PRIYA. His eyes slowly turn red. His
breathing quickens.

AARAV

Why don't you believe me? I'm telling
the truth! She's filling my eyes with
rage... controlling my body.

AARAV's eyes are completely red. His muscles tense.

SATYAVATI and PRIYA look at each other. Their eyes widen.

They slowly step back.

SCENE 2

INT. AARAV'S HOME, LIVING ROOM - DAY

Characters: AARAV, THAKUMA

AARAV sits alone in the large living room, his hand buried in his
hair.

Despair and exhaustion shadow his face.

He pulls his hand away and leans back on the sofa. His eyes drift to
the portrait of an ancestor on the wall.

Slow footsteps are heard from behind.

THAKUMA (70, in a white sari, her face a mask of deep peace and
wisdom) slowly enters the living room.

She looks at AARAV, her expression calm. Her gaze is deep and
understanding.

AARAV turns, a question in his eyes.

THAKUMA comes to him and places a hand on his shoulder. In her other
hand, a glass of water.

THAKUMA

Drink some water, son. Sit, be calm.

AARAV takes the glass and sips some water.

THAKUMA

I know everything. Your mother and Priya have already told me.

AARAV lowers his head, sadness on his face.

AARAV

I don't understand anything, Grandma. What's happening to me?

THAKUMA gently strokes his back, lovingly.

THAKUMA

It's what you think, son. Maa Kali is within you.

AARAV jumps, looking up. Disbelief in his eyes.

AARAV

I can't control it, Grandma. She's controlling me. I'm scared of myself.

THAKUMA

Don't be afraid, my son. You are like your father.

AARAV looks at his grandmother's face, his lips parting in surprise.

AARAV

Father...?

THAKUMA

Yes, your father was also a vessel of that power. He served Maa and fought injustice.

THAKUMA pauses for a moment. Her eyes gaze into the distance, a shadow of sadness crossing them.

THAKUMA

This is our family tradition. Maa Kali chooses her own. This is your destiny.

AARAV clenches his fists. A look of resolve slowly returns to his face.

AARAV

Then what should I do, Grandma? How do I understand Maa?

THAKUMA

Accept her. Accept her will. She will never bring you harm. Because you are hers.

THAKUMA gently pulls AARAV's head towards her chest.

AARAV hugs his grandmother tightly. Tears stream down his face. The trembling in his body is no longer from fear, but from relief.

THAKUMA strokes his head.

SCENE 3

EXT. VILLAGE LANE TO DURGA MAUSI'S HOUSE - DAY

Characters: AARAV, THAKUMA

AARAV (30, dusty white pajamas and kurta, a deep worry on his face) walks down a dusty village road.

Small houses with old mud walls line both sides of the road. Silence everywhere.

Sunlight streams through the leaves of dense trees, falling onto the road.

A deep line furrows between Aarav's brows. His face shows a kind of indecision.

He passes by his own house. He stops for a moment, looking at the closed main door. The worry for his family is clear in his eyes.

FLASH - AARAV'S POV: Grandmother's peaceful face. A shadow of deep wisdom in her eyes.

THAKUMA (ECHOING)

Whatever you're thinking, it's true,
son. Goddess Kali resides within you.

Aarav clenches his teeth. He shakes his head and starts walking again.

Some village women drawing water at a well by the road fall silent when they see him. They start whispering.

Aarav doesn't look at them. His pace doesn't change.

He walks on. His destination is Durga Mausi's hut. It's located at the far end of the village.

A determined expression crosses his face. He wants to understand something.

He slowly clenches his fist, then opens it.

He walks a little faster. More strength fills his steps.

The hut of Durga Mausi is clearly visible down the winding road. A small basil plant grows near the hut.

Aarav takes a deep breath. He heads towards the hut.

SCENE 4

INT. DURGA MAUSI'S HUT - DAY

Characters: AARAV, DURGA MAUSI

DURGA MAUSI's small hut. Walls of mud, thatched roof. The interior is dim, but a photograph of an old Kali goddess, smeared with vermillion, is clearly visible in the light filtering in from outside.

In the center of the hut, DURGA MAUSI (70, thin, her spine bent from years of labor, in a white sari) sits slowly. She is calmly arranging

some dried leaves.

AARAV (30) steps into the hut. His face is a mixture of worry and fear.

DURGA MAUSI

Come in, come in, son... I knew you'd come.

A strange peace in Mausi's voice.

Aarav sits down beside her. His head is bowed.

AARAV

Mausi... I'm scared.

AARAV

Mom... How could I... How could I raise my hand to her? What's happening to me?

Aarav shivers. His voice breaks.

DURGA MAUSI

The power of Mother Kali. It has awakened within you.

Mausi takes Aarav's hand. Her hand is soft, but strong.

DURGA MAUSI

But that power never strikes the innocent. How could you raise your hand against your own mother?

AARAV

(ଆଶ୍ଚର୍ଯ୍ୟରେ)

You mean... it wasn't me? (surprised)

DURGA MAUSI

No, son. The rule of Mother Kali's power within you is different. She comes to establish righteousness, to protect the innocent.

Mausi looks towards the photograph of the Kali goddess.

DURGA MAUSI

That power is unleashed against those who commit injustice, who sin.

DURGA MAUSI

Your mother is innocent. It's impossible to lay a hand on her.

Aarav seems to shed his worry upon hearing Mausi's words. His shoulders lighten slightly.

AARAV

Then my blackouts...

DURGA MAUSI

You weren't conscious then. Mother
Kali used your body. But your inner
soul, your love for the innocent in
your body, didn't let that power
strike your mother.

Aarav slowly raises his head and looks at Mausi. His eyes are now filled with reassurance, and some questions.

AARAV

This power... then why did I get it?

DURGA MAUSI

Your father's blood runs in you. Your family has made many sacrifices before for the protection of this village.

DURGA MAUSI

Mother has chosen you. To complete her work.

Mausi looks again at the photograph of the Kali goddess. Deep faith on her face.

Aarav looks at the photograph of the goddess. A new, heavy feeling inside him, the beginning of a new responsibility.

SCENE 5

INT. AARAV'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

The darkness of night has enveloped Aarav's house. A faint light spills from his bedroom doorway.

AARAV (30) sits on his bed, legs folded in a lotus position. Before him, a small brass lamp glows, casting a soft light.

He takes a deep breath and exhales. A slight tremor runs through him.

DURGA MAUSI (ECHOING)

The Mother has chosen you... to complete her work.

Aarav closes his eyes.

His brow furrows. His eyelids flutter.

Suddenly, a flash. A hazy shape of light and shadow appears.

He shakes his head, clenches his fists, and squeezes his eyes tighter.

AARAV

Clearer... I want to know.

He takes another deep breath. His body tenses.

This time, the flash is clearer. The scene of a room comes into focus.

The interior of a large, old house. Stone walls. Dim light from

earthen lamps. Papers scattered everywhere.

Aarav's breathing slows. His face looks vacant, as if he's somewhere else.

MAHANT (60, dressed in a white dhoti-kurta) is seated, opening a large, ancient palm-leaf manuscript. Around him lie numerous diagrams and land deeds. He is searching for something. Deep furrows crease his brow.

Aarav's eyes widen slightly. He stares intently at the Mahant.

The Mahant shakes his head. His lips tighten. He mutters something to himself, inaudible.

Aarav's head tilts forward slightly, as if trying to hear. But only indistinct echoes.

The Mahant suddenly picks up a small, black object from his desk. It is eye-shaped. In the lamplight, it emits a faint sheen.

Aarav's body jolts. His eyes snap open.

He breathes heavily, exhausted. Sweat beads on his skin. His body trembles.

He looks at his hands. Opens and closes his fists.

The image dances before his eyes: the Mahant, and that eye-shaped object.

AARAV

The eye... what was that?

He slowly gets off the bed.

He goes to the window. Outside, it's a pitch-dark night.

A gust of cold wind blows through the window crack, making him shiver.

His expression hardens. A new resolve appears in his eyes.

He closes his eyes again for a moment. The image of the Mahant and the eye-shaped object flashes before him.

He opens his eyes, a new determination in his gaze.

SCENE 6

INT. AARAV'S HOME, KITCHEN - DAY

Characters: AARAV, PRIYA

AARAV (30) sits quietly by the small kitchen table. Half-eaten food is before him.

His eyes are fixed on a spot on the wall.

PRIYA (28) enters the kitchen slowly.

Her hair is messy, and the skin under her eyes is dark. She looks sleep-deprived.

She stops at the doorway, her gaze fixed on AARAV.

AARAV looks up, meeting her gaze.

AARAV

You still don't believe me, Priya? I told you everything.

PRIYA

Aarav... what are you doing? You're completely...

Priya takes two steps forward. Her arms are crossed over her chest.

AARAV

I'm just looking for the truth, Priya.

PRIYA

The truth? What truth? About the priest stealing eyes that you yourself saw at night...?

Her voice trembles.

PRIYA

This will kill you! It will take your life.

AARAV looks directly into her eyes. His face is unreadable.

AARAV

I can't stop it, Priya.

PRIYA

Why can't you? Don't you understand, this isn't a game. Everything here is dangerous!

PRIYA

I don't want to lose you.

AARAV slowly clenches his fists. A resolve lights up in his eyes.

AARAV

Mother chose me, Priya. This is my destiny.

PRIYA

Mother chose you? You've gone completely mad. What are you saying?

PRIYA

Come on, Aarav... let's get out of here. Let's go now.

PRIYA

Don't you understand, you're not safe here anymore. Truly not safe.

AARAV stands up, taller than PRIYA.

AARAV

I'm not leaving. I have to finish my work.

Hearing him, Priya clenches her fists and falls silent. Her face pales.

PRIYA

You're not the same Aarav anymore...
you've completely changed.

SCENE 7

INT. AARAV'S HOME, LIVING ROOM - DAY

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI

AARAV stands in the living room, staring at the spot where PRIYA left some time ago.

A profound silence on his face.

SATYAVATI (50s, in a white sari, worry etched on her face) slowly walks in from the kitchen.

She carries a puja thali, stacked with items.

She looks at AARAV, a tremor runs through her body.

SATYAVATI

AARAV... Priya left crying... Don't
you understand, son?

AARAV looks at her. His eyes hold gentleness, but also a hardness.

AARAV

Mom, I know you and Priya are worried
about me.

SATYAVATI

(ଅସହାୟ ଭାବେ)
Worried? What else would we be? Do you
think this is all okay? Your father is
gone... and you too... [helplessly]

Her voice cracks.

SATYAVATI

There are police, there is the law. If
you tell them, you'll get justice,
right? Why should we get involved in
all this?

AARAV

(ନିମ୍ନ ସ୍ବରରେ)
Mom, this isn't about the police or
the law. The Mahant... I saw him
clearly last night. [in a low voice]

SATYAVATI's hand holding the puja thali trembles.

AARAV

He was looking at the temple's documents... and in his hand, he held Mother's eye.

Hearing AARAV's words, SATYAVATI's lips quiver.

SATYAVATI

Wh-what are you saying? A dream... You must have seen a dream.

AARAV

It wasn't a dream, Mom. This is all real. Mother is showing me. She is within me.

SATYAVATI places a hand on her chest.

SATYAVATI

AARAV... this has never happened before. You studied, you worked outside... why are you getting involved in the superstitions of our village?

AARAV

(ଧୀର ସ୍ବରରେ, ନିଶ୍ଚିତ ଭାବେ)
I'm not the AARAV who worked outside anymore, Mom. I am the son in whom Mother resides. [softly, with certainty]

SATYAVATI

(ଆଖିରେ ଲୁହ ଜଳେଇ ଆସିଲା)
Yo-you too, like your father... will you leave me and go? [her eyes welling up]

AARAV walks towards her. His expression is grave.

AARAV

I am not leaving you, Mom. I am only doing my duty. What Mother wants.

He looks at SATYAVATI's face, sees the fear in her eyes.

AARAV

That Mahant stole Mother's eye. He will be punished. This is Mother's decision.

SATYAVATI shivers. She looks at AARAV with an unfamiliar gaze.

It feels as if she isn't looking at her own son, but at someone else.

AARAV makes a firm decision in his mind.

AARAV

I will follow Mother's path. Whatever it takes.

SATYAVATI bows her head silently, tears streaming down her cheeks.
She knows now, no one can stop AARAV.
AARAV turns to leave the house.

SCENE 8

EXT. VILLAGE CHOWK, GATHERING - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MAHANTA, VILLAGERS

The village square is crowded. Men and women from the village have gathered. They're talking loudly.

In the middle, there's a puffed rice stall. Sunlight falls in front of it.

AARAV (28, ordinary pants and shirt) stands a little distance away, watching everything. There's a steady look in his eyes.

MAHANTA (60, white kurta, sandalwood tilak on his forehead) sits on a raised platform. He holds a magazine.

Some village elders are also seated near him.

MAHANTA begins to say something about the village's progress.

AARAV slowly walks forward. His presence goes unnoticed.

MAHANTA finishes speaking. Some people clap.

AARAV clears his throat. Everyone turns to look at him.

AARAV

May I say something, Mahanta Baba?

MAHANTA looks at AARAV. A slight frown on his face.

MAHANTA

(ଧୀର ସ୍ବରରେ)

Yes, speak, Aarav. What do you have to say? [in a calm voice]

AARAV

There are still many people in our village who treat God as a business. They misuse faith for their own selfish gain.

The villagers start murmuring. Some people look at MAHANTA.

AARAV

Those who steal sacred symbols and hide them in their dark rooms, Mother will never forgive them.

As AARAV finishes speaking, he looks directly into MAHANTA's eyes.

MAHANTA's face turns pale. A flicker appears in his eyes – a mixture of fear and anger.

He unnaturally adjusts his kurta.

AARAV's gaze doesn't leave him. He stands silently, observing MAHANTA's unease.

MAHANTA tries to compose himself, but his hands are trembling. He knows AARAV is onto him.

SCENE 9

EXT. AARAV'S HOME, DOORSTEP - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV

In the darkness of the night, AARAV (30, dressed in city clothes, worry etched on his face) walks onto his porch.

The night is silent, save for the long chirping of crickets all around.

He steps up onto the porch.

His foot strikes something. A soft thud.

AARAV looks down. His breath catches.

Lying on the porch is a simple clay idol of Maa Kali.

The idol is crudely made, as if crafted in haste.

The eyes have been gouged out. The sockets are empty.

AARAV stares at the idol, unblinking.

His body tenses slightly.

He slowly kneels before the idol. His hands tremble.

With his finger, he touches the place where the eyes should be.

AARAV lifts the idol, bringing it close to his chest.

A change comes over his face. His eyes harden with resolve.

He lifts his head, gazing into the distant darkness. A clear decision is etched on his face.

SCENE 10

INT. MAHANTA'S STUDY - NIGHT

Characters: MAHANTA, RAGHU

MAHANTA (60, dressed in white dhoti and kurta, his face a mask of anger and worry) paces restlessly in his study.

Books and papers are scattered haphazardly on the table. He slams a hand down on one of the books.

Beads of sweat gather on his forehead.

RAGHU (35, dressed in black, unmoving) stands by the doorway.

Mahanta looks at him. His eyelids narrow.

MAHANTA

Ar... Ar... How dare he say that to me
in court today?

Mahanta bites down on his lower lip.

MAHANTA

That idol... what game is this?

Raghu remains still. His eyes are fixed on Mahanta.

Mahanta slowly walks towards Raghu. His eyes hold a sharp glint.

MAHANTA

He will leave. Leave the village for
good.

Raghu shakes his head. His expression doesn't change.

Raghu turns his back and leaves without a sound.

Mahanta collapses onto the chair. His hands fall to his chest.

He looks at a small clay idol on the table. The black paint on its
eyes is slightly faded.

Mahanta picks up the idol. He runs a finger over its eyes. His
fingers tremble slightly.

Mahanta presses his lips together. A cold, ruthless spark flashes in
his eyes.

He gently places the idol back on the table.

EPISODE 7: UNMASKING MAHANTA

SCENE 1

EXT. MAHANTA'S PROPERTY, NEAR OLD WELL - NIGHT

Characters: RAGHU

A dark night. RAGHU (35, dressed simply, worry etched on his face) walks slowly towards an old well on MAHANTA's land. He carries a large sack.

He keeps looking around. No one is there. It's a deserted spot.

He stops near the mouth of the old well, hidden by wild bushes. A foul stench emanates from the well.

RAGHU opens the sack. It's filled with old books, ledgers, and papers.

He starts tossing the ledgers into the well, one by one. His hands tremble as he throws them.

Suddenly, a faint buzzing sound is heard. RAGHU pauses, listening.

The sound gradually grows louder, seeming to come from inside the well.

He's about to throw another ledger when an insect buzzes near his ear. He tries to swat it.

Suddenly, a swarm of bees flies out of the well. A dim blue light emanates from their bodies. RAGHU stares, mouth agape in astonishment.

The swarm of bees circles around him, their buzzing now sounding like a terrible roar.

Terrified, he screams and throws the sack away. The ledgers scatter everywhere.

The bees begin to land on his body, stinging him.

RAGHU covers his face with his hands and tries to run.

He runs erratically, stumbling every few steps.

He slips and falls to the ground. The swarm of bees engulfs him. He cries out in pain.

Writhing in agony, he gets back on his feet. His body is covered in welts.

He somehow flees, getting away from the well. Muffled sounds escape his mouth.

He stops some distance away and looks back. The swarm of bees is still flying around the well, their blue glow clearly visible.

RAGHU begins to tremble with fear. His face is pale.

He slowly backs away further, then turns and runs rapidly into the darkness.

The buzzing of the bees gradually subsides. Their blue light flickers near the well, indicating they are still there.

SCENE 2

EXT. VILLAGE LANE, SECLUDED - DAY

Characters: AARAV, RAGHU

A deserted lane in the village. The midday sun beats down on the dirt road.

RAGHU (35, eyes darting nervously) walks, kicking up dust.

Traces of bee stings from the previous night are still visible on his body. He keeps glancing over his shoulder.

Emerging from the turn of the lane, AARAV (25, simply dressed, his face unreadable) stands blocking Raghu's path.

Raghu stops short. He flinches and steps back the moment his eyes meet Aarav's.

Aarav's gaze is fixed on Raghu.

AARAV

What's wrong, Raghu-bhai? Where are you off to?

Raghu quickly looks down, fussing with his clothes. His hands tremble.

RAGHU

No... nowhere. Just... came out for some air.

Aarav takes a slow step forward. His expression remains calm.

AARAV

Your face is pale. You don't look well. Didn't sleep well last night?

Raghu glances around nervously. His face grows even paler.

RAGHU

No... everything's fine. Must be the sun.

AARAV

What can the sun do? When Mother Kali opens her eyes, everything turns to darkness.

Hearing Aarav's words, Raghu shivers. He clenches his fists tightly.

AARAV

Remember... Balaram Sahu?

Raghu's eyes widen. He tries to speak but can't. His lips tremble.

AARAV

(ଧୀର ସ୍ବରରେ)

When he tried to seize Mother's
land... how it all ended. His
cattle... his wealth... (in a soft
voice)

Aarav's voice is devoid of emotion, yet each word instills fear in
Raghu.

AARAV

As a man, he's cunning, he can hide
anything. But who escapes the eyes of
Mother Kali?

Raghu's body begins to tremble violently. He opens his mouth to
speak, but no sound comes out.

AARAV

Anyone who wrongs Mother... helps the
wrongdoer... Mother will not forgive
them.

Aarav's gaze locks onto Raghu's eyes. There's a steadiness in his
look, but a reflection of an unknown power within.

Raghu stands with his head bowed. He doesn't dare to look up. He's
forgotten to even breathe.

SCENE 3

INT. AARAV'S HOME, VERANDA - DAY

Characters: DURGA, AARAV

RAGHU bursts out of the house, his feet in a hurry.

His lips tremble, his eyes dart around nervously.

He glances over his shoulder once, then quickly slips into the alley.

DURGA MAUSI (65, wearing a white sari, her face grim) stands on the
verandah.

She watches RAGHU leave.

She looks towards the inner room, where AARAV (25, in simple white
clothes) stands by the door.

DURGA

Raghu left without eating, Aarav?

AARAV slowly comes onto the verandah and stands beside DURGA MAUSI.

AARAV

He was busy, Grandma.

DURGA

Busy? His face looked so drawn. Who
scared him so much?

AARAV turns to face the alley. His expression is unreadable.

AARAV

One reaps what one sows, Grandma.

DURGA MAUSI moves closer to AARAV.

She places a hand on AARAV's shoulder.

DURGA

The truth never stays hidden, son.

AARAV looks up, meeting DURGA MAUSI's eyes.

DURGA

Mother's eyes see everything. Just be brave.

AARAV nods slowly.

SCENE 4

EXT. VILLAGE TEMPLE GROUNDS - NIGHT

Characters: Raghu, Aarav

The temple courtyard is dark all around. Only a dim light filters from a smoky lantern in one corner.

From the darkness, RAGHU (35, his face pale with fear and anxiety) emerges, walking as if trembling. His body seems drained of blood.

He approaches AARAV (25, calm and steady) standing on the temple steps.

RAGHU

Aarav...

Raghu's voice is shaky.

AARAV

What happened?

RAGHU

I... I see those bees everywhere... those eyes. I'm so scared.

Aarav moves a little closer to him. His eyes are expressionless.

AARAV

Fear will always grip those who do wrong. No one can stop Mother Kali's will. Her reckoning is not yet complete.

Raghu shivers. He clutches his arm.

RAGHU

I... I wasn't involved. I'm innocent. I was just following MAHANTA's orders.

AARAV

Mother Kali does not punish the

innocent. But she doesn't spare those
who aid wrongdoing either. All truths
will be revealed before her.

Raghu's shoulders slump. Helplessness washes over his face.

RAGHU

I... I'll tell you everything.
Whatever I know... Save me.

Aarav watches him silently. His expression and tone remain unchanged.

RAGHU

(ଓଛୁକୁ ହୋଇ)
Tonight... at the ruined temple by the
new pond. Midnight. No one will know.

Aarav slowly nods.

Raghu spins around instantly, nearly stumbling. He disappears into
the darkness.

Aarav remains standing there. His gaze drifts up towards the dark
spire of the temple.

SCENE 5

INT. ABANDONED HUT NEAR TEMPLE - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, RAGHU

Inside a dilapidated hut, shrouded in darkness, a dim light flickers
from a torch. The air is thick with the smell of dust and old wood.

RAGHU stumbles into the hut, his legs trembling. He glances around
fearfully, his breathing rapid.

AARAV sits in a corner of the hut, slumped on a broken stone. He
waits in silence.

RAGHU

Aarav... save me... Mother Kali...
don't abandon me.

Raghav clasps his hands together, as if pleading.

AARAV

Speak. Say what you have to say.

Aarav's voice is devoid of emotion, carrying only a grave tone.

RAGHU

Mahant... it's all his doing. His
greed... he planned to steal Mother
Kali's eyes. For a long time now...
for wealth... for power.

As Raghav speaks, his eyes dart around. He feels as though someone is
watching him.

RAGHU

He bribed me... and a few others. We broke into the temple in the dead of night. Those eyes... we snatched them away.

Raghav covers his face with his hands. A shiver runs down his spine.

RAGHU

That day... in the morning... he framed your father. The Mahant said if your father took the blame for the theft, we'd all be spared. So... so...

Raghav's voice cracks, his face pale. His eyes well up with tears.

RAGHU

The eyes... the eyes are still in the old well behind the Mahant's house. He's hidden them there.

Aarav frowns. A look of determination flashes in his eyes.

RAGHU

And he... he wants to destroy all the evidence... like the account books. Tomorrow, in the chaos of the festival... no one will know.

Raghav slumps, his shoulders drooping. He lowers his head.

RAGHU

I've told you everything... Forgive me... Please forgive me, Aarav.

Aarav slowly stands up. There's a newfound strength in his stride.

He walks out of the hut without a word. The torchlight casts a long shadow of him.

SCENE 6

INT. AARAV'S HOME, LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Characters: AARAV, SATYAVATI, PRIYA

AARAV (25, dusty, tired, eyes wide) enters the living room of the house.

SATYAVATI (60, in a white sari, her face etched with worry and fatigue) and PRIYA (25, in simple clothes, anxious) sit waiting on the sofa.

Aarav goes and sits down slowly in front of them. A heavy silence falls over the room.

AARAV

Raghav told you everything. The Mahant framed my father. He's the one who stole Mother Kali's eyes too.

Satyavati's eyes well up. She reaches out her hands towards Aarav.

SATYAVATI

I knew it! My son is innocent! My husband is innocent! We have to call the police now. That Mahant, right now...

Satyavati gets up from the sofa, moving towards the door.

AARAV

The eyes are still in the Mahant's well behind his house. He's trying to destroy all the evidence at the fair tomorrow.

Satyavati stops. She turns back and looks at Aarav.

PRIYA

Mom, sit down. Aarav is right.

Priya gently pulls Satyavati back to the sofa. She looks directly at Aarav. Her voice is pleading, her eyes fearful.

PRIYA

Now... now we go straight to the police. Don't face this danger alone, Aarav. If something happens to you... what will happen to us?

Aarav sits silently. He looks back and forth between Priya and Satyavati. The tips of his ears are red. He presses his lips together.

SATYAVATI

Why are you silent, Aarav? After hearing all this, you're not saying anything. Your father's name is cleared. No one will suspect you now.

Aarav shifts his gaze from the small photo of Mother Kali in the corner of the room.

PRIYA

Mom's right. This is your duty! To your family, to both of us. Why are you suddenly... wanting to walk into such great danger?

Aarav slowly gets up from the sofa. He looks towards the door.

AARAV

If we want to clear my father's name, this is what we have to do.

Satyavati and Priya exchange a worried glance. Aarav's back is to them. He stares resolutely at the door.

SCENE 7

EXT. VILLAGE PCO BOOTH - DAY

Characters: AARAV, PCO OPERATOR

AARAV (30, in a faded grey shirt, an intense look in his eyes) steps into the old PCO booth in the center of the village. The booth is dark inside, phone wires tangled everywhere.

The PCO OPERATOR (50, thick glasses, white kurta, reading a newspaper on the table) looks up.

AARAV

I need to make a phone call. An urgent one.

PCO OPERATOR

Who should I connect you to?

AARAV

The 'Dainik Samachar' newspaper office in Bhubaneswar. Connect me to this number.

Aarav reaches out and hands over a small piece of paper. The PCO Operator slowly dials the number.

After a few rings, he hands the phone to Aarav.

AARAV

Hello. This is Aarav speaking. From Ramabhadrapur village. I have an important news item to report.

Aarav holds the phone to his ear, listening silently to the other side.

AARAV

(ସ୍ଵରରେ ଦୃଢ଼ତା ଭାରି)
Tomorrow is the annual fair in Ramabhadrapur. On that day, the stolen eyes of Goddess Kali and the real culprit will be revealed to everyone.

The PCO Operator stares at Aarav, surprise and confusion on his face. Aarav ignores him, focused on his call.

AARAV

Justice will be served! You must reach our village before the fair begins tomorrow.

He waits a bit longer. Hearing the response from the other end, he nods.

AARAV

Understood. Thank you. Time is running out.

Aarav hangs up the phone. His face wears a look of quiet pride. He

looks at the PCO Operator.

AARAV

How much do I owe?

The PCO Operator checks the meter and tells him the amount. Aarav pays him and walks out of the booth.

He doesn't look back. His feet carry him forward, towards the sounds of the fair.

SCENE 8

INT. MAHANTA'S STUDY - DAY

Characters: MAHANTA

MAHANTA (55, dressed in a white Punjabi, clean-shaven, but his face is etched with worry, his eyes burning with anger) sits in his large study. An old radio is placed in front of him. AARAV's voice emanates from the radio.

AARAV

(from the radio)

The stolen eyes of Kali Ma, and the true culprit behind it, will be revealed for all to see. Justice will be served!

MAHANTA's lips tighten. His fists clench.

He slams his hand down on the radio, silencing it. The radio tumbles to the floor.

He stands up. Muffled sounds escape his lips.

He quickly opens a heavy iron safe near the table. He pulls out some thick ledgers and old papers.

Carrying them, he walks over to an iron box in the corner. It's used for burning trash.

He throws the ledgers and papers into the box. He then pours some flammable liquid (lighter fluid) from a can onto them.

He strikes a match and sets them alight. The ledgers immediately catch fire. Smoke fills the room.

MAHANTA watches the burning papers, his breathing quickening. He picks up his mobile phone.

He dials a number. He waits.

MAHANTA

Hello... This is Mahanta. Why haven't you shut down that news yet?

He pulls the phone slightly away from his ear in anger, then puts it back after a few seconds.

MAHANTA

(shouting)
What are you saying? It's impossible?
How can that be?

His face turns red. He walks to the window and looks outside. The faint sounds of the fair can be heard.

MAHANTA

Listen... I need to leave tonight. The car should reach the spot behind the temple just before the fair begins. No one will see.

Something is heard from the other end. MAHANTA nods his head.

MAHANTA

Yes... I'll be waiting there. Amidst the fair's crowd, no one will find me. I'll disappear like this, and no one will know.

He hangs up the phone. Smoke rises from the burning papers. A small, unsettling smile plays on his lips.

SCENE 9

EXT. VILLAGE SQUARE, FAIR GROUNDS - DAY

Characters: AARAV

The fairground buzzes with energy. The scent of fried dough and sweets drifts on the breeze.

Colorful canopies stretch over makeshift stalls. The sound of a drum echoes from a corner.

The squeak of a metal swing set mingles with the laughter of children.

AARAV (28, in a white kurta and simple pants) slowly enters the crowd.

His gaze is steady. His footsteps are deliberate, measured.

Near a stall, an artisan adds the final touches of paint to a clay idol of Kali Ma.

The final stroke of black paint is drawn along the Mother's eyes.

AARAV's steps halt abruptly. He stares at the idol for a long moment.

SATYAVATI (ECHOING)

To stand by and watch injustice is the greatest sin, Aarav.

AARAV clenches his fists. His breathing deepens slightly.

He tears his eyes from the idol. An unshakeable resolve hardens his gaze.

He looks towards the white spire of the distant temple, gleaming in the sun.

A faint, serious smile plays on AARAV's lips.

The sounds and movement of the fair swirl around him, but AARAV's face remains still and somber.

He slowly starts walking again.

His feet carry him towards the main stage of the fair.

There's a sense of determination in every step he takes.

EPISODE 8: THE FINAL FIGHT

SCENE 1

EXT. RAMABHADIPUR ANNUAL FAIR ENTRANCE - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MOTHER, GRANDMOTHER, PRIYA

RAMBHADRAPUR ANNUAL FAIRGROUND. The place is teeming with people.

Colorful banners flutter in the breeze. Stalls selling toys and sweets are doing brisk business.

The air is alive with the chatter of children, conversations, and the calls of vendors.

We push through the crowd: AARAV (25, dressed casually, sharp eyes), his MOTHER (50, calm demeanor, in a blue sari), GRANDMOTHER (70, in a white sari), and little sister PRIYA (10, in a colorful frock).

Priya claps and runs ahead, her face alight with the fair's excitement.

PRIYA

Priya: Bhai! Look, such pretty toys!
Can we ride that swing horse?

Aarav manages a small smile and looks at Priya. His eyes scan every face in the crowd.

AARAV

Aarav: Yes, dear, of course, we can.
Let's walk around a bit first. Don't
wander off.

Mother takes Aarav's arm. Her fingers grip his for a moment.

MOTHER

Mother: Stay alert, Aarav.

Grandmother adjusts the cloth bag on her shoulder. Her gaze calmly sweeps over the moving crowd.

GRANDMOTHER

Grandmother: If Mother Kali wills it,
she herself will bring him back.

Aarav's eyes lock onto a tall man in the distance. He freezes.

Aarav pushes forward a few quick steps into the crowd, raising his head to see over people.

The man turns. It's not MAHANTA. Aarav's shoulders slump slightly.

He lets out a slow breath.

PRIYA

Priya: What's wrong, Bhai? Who are you
looking for?

Aarav forces a quick smile.

AARAV

Aarav: Nothing... no one. Just looking around. You enjoy the fair.

Mother and Grandmother exchange a meaningful glance.

They slowly move deeper into the fair, surrounded by the noise and laughter.

Aarav's face hardens, his jaw tightens.

His eyes dart continuously over every face.

He stops by a toy stall, lingering behind his family as if looking at something.

But his head turns slightly, his eyes piercing the crowd.

MOTHER

Mother: Don't go too far. Be careful.

Aarav nods, a small, curt movement, without looking at them.

His eyes fix on a distant point, his posture alert and ready.

SCENE 2

EXT. RAMABHADIPUR ANNUAL FAIR, SECLUDED CORNER - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MOTHER, GRANDMOTHER, PRIYA

As they walked deeper into the fair, they slowly reached a slightly secluded spot. The noise of the fair was less audible here.

Priya spotted a colorful pinwheel stall and shouted.

PRIYA

Oh, Mom! Look how it spins! I want that one.

Mother took Priya by the hand and led her forward. Aarav was still observing their surroundings with a watchful eye.

GRANDMOTHER (70s, in a white sari, her face etched with strength and experience) stopped Aarav by holding his hand.

Aarav looked towards his Grandmother. Her face was serene.

GRANDMOTHER

Aarav... your father walked the righteous path. He was a simple man. He did no wrong.

A faint trace of pain crossed Aarav's face. He lowered his head.

GRANDMOTHER

Mother Kali guides those who truly seek justice. But there's one condition.

Aarav looked up, his eyes meeting his Grandmother's.

AARAV

(ଧୀର ସ୍ବରରେ)

What condition, Grandma? (softly)

GRANDMOTHER

If they surrender themselves
completely to Mother's will. If they
lay all their fears, all their greed,
all their anger at her feet.

Aarav pondered her words. The idea of surrender felt daunting.

GRANDMOTHER

That surrender holds the true power,
child. Not your power, but Mother's
power.

As Grandmother finished speaking, Mother arrived with Priya, drawing closer to them.

Mother looked at Aarav with a wistful gaze.

Grandmother placed her hand on Aarav's shoulder. A unique sense of peace emanated from her touch.

Aarav slowly nodded. A shadow of a serious decision flickered in his eyes. The words seemed to sink deep within him.

He looked towards the main path of the fair. The crowd was still dense.

AARAV

I understand, Grandma.

Grandmother gently squeezed Aarav's hand, a look of relief on her face. She smiled at Aarav with a look of trust.

Mother gave Aarav a slight encouraging pat on the arm.

Aarav took a deep breath. It felt as if something within him had changed. As if he no longer belonged to himself.

They re-entered the hustle and bustle of the fair. This time, Aarav's steps were firmer, more assured.

SCENE 3

EXT. RAMABHADIPUR ANNUAL FAIR, CROWDED PATHWAYS - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MAHANTA, MOTHER, GRANDMOTHER, PRIYA

Amidst the fair's crowd, MAHANTA (55, in dusty white clothes, fear in his eyes) tries to slip away unnoticed. He glances around, avoiding eye contact. One hand is tucked into his left pocket.

He's looking for a way out of the fair.

AARAV scanned the fairgrounds, his eyes searching the crowds.

At a specific moment, AARAV's gaze landed on MAHANTA. MAHANTA was repeatedly looking around, as if searching for someone.

AARAV's face hardened. He's tracking MAHANTA's every move.

MAHANTA began walking quickly through the crowd, head down, as if trying to disappear.

Seeing AARAV's expression, MOTHER grew worried.

MOTHER grabbed AARAV's arm, stopping him.

MOTHER

What is it, Aarav? Did you see someone?

AARAV nodded in the direction MAHANTA was heading.

AARAV

Mom, Grandma, Priya. You all stay right here. Near this stall. Don't move. I'll be right back.

Fear flickered in MOTHER's eyes. She tried to hold AARAV back.

MOTHER

(ହଲିଯାଇ)

Where are you going? What happened?
[parenthetical: shaken]

GRANDMOTHER gently squeezed MOTHER's hand. She looked towards AARAV.

GRANDMOTHER

Let him go. Don't worry.

AARAV didn't wait for them any longer. He started running after MAHANTA, his eyes fixed on him.

MAHANTA realized he was being followed. Without turning, he walked faster, trying to lose himself in the crowd.

Children's toys, balloons, and stalls obstructed MAHANTA's path.

AARAV pushed through the crowd, moving fast, shoving people aside.

PRIYA clutched MOTHER's sari in fear. MOTHER's eyes welled up with tears.

GRANDMOTHER watched AARAV in the distance, a calm expression on her face. She glanced towards a photo of Maa Kali.

MAHANTA ran towards the edge of the fair. He knew his vehicle was there.

AARAV was right behind him. His breathing quickened, but his resolve was firm.

The noise of the fair began to fade. But AARAV's footsteps now sounded even clearer.

SCENE 4

EXT. RAMABHADIPUR ANNUAL FAIR, EDGE OF FAIR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MAHANTA

Weaving through the fair's crowd, MAHANTA (55, in dusty white robes, fear in his eyes) finally reached his old Ambassador car.

A flicker of relief crossed his face. He reached quickly for the car door handle.

Quick footsteps pounded from behind.

AARAV (30, sharp, neat attire, a determined resolve in his eyes) came running, blocking MAHANTA's path.

MAHANTA jumped, pulling his hand back. Fear and the urge to flee were in his eyes.

AARAV

Where else would you go, Mahanta? You have to tell me the truth today!

AARAV's voice was laced with unyielding anger, his body taut.

MAHANTA

(ଦାଢ଼ି ଶୁଖି ଯାଉଛି)
(Voice dry) The truth... I don't know anything... Go away, don't scare me.

MAHANTA's hand slowly moved towards his left pocket.

AARAV

Why did you kill my father? Why did you steal Mother Kali's eyes?

A cruel smile played on MAHANTA's lips. He pulled a small, sharp knife from his pocket.

The knife's blade glinted in the sunlight. A shadow of shock and danger crossed AARAV's face.

MAHANTA

(କ୍ରୋଧରେ)
You'll end up like your father! I won't let you go!

MAHANTA lunged at AARAV like a madman. The knife lunged towards AARAV's chest.

AARAV recoiled at the last second. The knife grazed his left arm, coming terrifyingly close.

They grappled around the car. MAHANTA tried to attack with the knife, AARAV struggled to defend himself.

AARAV grabbed MAHANTA's hand, trying to push the knife away. Pain and struggle contorted his face.

A ruthless glint in MAHANTA's eyes. He tried to throw AARAV to the ground.

AARAV's breathing grew rapid. His muscles ached. He was at the absolute limit of his strength.

MAHANTA aimed the knife at AARAV's stomach and struck with powerful force.

SCENE 5

EXT. RAMABHADIPUR ANNUAL FAIR, EDGE OF FAIR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MAHANTA

MAHANTA's knife is pressed against AARAV's stomach. AARAV, with his last ounce of strength, grips MAHANTA's hand.

AARAV's face turns red, his breathing growing rapid. His muscles tremble.

MAHANTA strains to push the knife deeper. A twisted look of victory in his eyes.

Suddenly, an unnatural calm washes over AARAV's body. The expression on his face changes.

AARAV's gaze drifts slightly upward. His eyes are wide open, but he seems not to be seeing anything.

A soft, deep hum emanates from within AARAV's chest. It slowly begins to grow.

MAHANTA's eyes widen. He stares at AARAV's face, his grip on the knife weakening.

From the din of the fair, a small, distinct sound cuts through the atmosphere. A scream is heard. MAHANTA looks around wildly.

AARAV deliberately closes his eyes, slowly. A new expression of peace settles on his face.

A powerful gust of wind blows. A great cloud of dust swirls around AARAV.

AARAV's body straightens. His shoulders seem broader, his feet more firmly planted on the ground.

Slowly, his eyelids flutter open.

His eyes no longer hold human emotion. They are deep, black, and burning like fire.

A strange, ominous light emanates from those eyes. As if someone else was looking out from within them.

MAHANTA shivers at the sight. The color drains from his face.

The knife slips from his hand. It clatters to the ground.

MAHANTA stumbles backward in fear. He trips over his own feet, about to fall.

AARAV now stands completely still. His gaze falls upon MAHANTA with

an unearthly intensity.

SCENE 6

EXT. RAMABHADIPUR ANNUAL FAIR, EDGE OF FAIR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MAHANTA

AARAV stands still, his gaze fixed on MAHANTA.

MAHANTA scrambles backward on the ground in terror. His eyes dart toward the car.

AARAV slowly raises his hand toward the car. His fingers twitch.

At that moment, the engine of the black car MAHANTA is in sputters to life.

The car lurches forward and back, shaking.

MAHANTA reaches out in panic, trying to open the car door. It's stuck.

The engine's sputtering turns into a harsh roar.

All four wheels spin uselessly on the ground. The acrid smell of burning rubber and a deafening screech fill the air.

MAHANTA pounds on the door. His face drains of color.

Suddenly, flames erupt from the car's engine, licking outwards.

MAHANTA is trapped inside the car. He screams.

Fire rapidly engulfs the front of the car. Black smoke billows into the sky.

MAHANTA screams louder, but his cries are drowned out by the roar of the fire.

AARAV remains motionless. His eyes are fixed on the flames.

The fairgoers recoil in fear, and a heavy silence falls.

CUT TO:

SCENE 7

EXT. RAMABHADIPUR ANNUAL FAIR, CENTER - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MAHANTA, AARAV's Mother, AARAV's Grandmother, PRIYA, Villagers

AARAV stands resolute before the burning car, his gaze fixed on MAHANTA.

Gasping for air in the smoke, MAHANTA pounds desperately on the car door from inside.

The fairgoers retreat in terror, forming a semicircle. Their faces show panic and disbelief.

Slowly, AARAV extends his hand toward MAHANTA. His fingers curl into a fist.

MAHANTA's body shakes violently. A choked sound escapes his throat.

The car door creaks open.

Stumbling out of the thick smoke, MAHANTA coughs, his clothes singed in places.

He coughs hard, his eyes wide, darting around.

AARAV takes a step forward, his intense gaze locked on MAHANTA.

MAHANTA looks around fearfully, his lips trembling.

MAHANTA stumbles forward, walking toward the center of the fair.

AARAV's mother and grandmother watch silently. Tears well up in the mother's eyes. The grandmother's face is set with resolve.

PRIYA bites her lip, fear and shock in her eyes.

AARAV

Tell me, MAHANTA. Tell me everything
you've done.

MAHANTA's legs tremble. He clutches his neck, coughing.

AARAV

The flames will force the truth out of
you. Tell them you stole Mother Kali's
eyes... tell them you killed my father!

MAHANTA

Yes... Yes... I stole them! I stole
Mother Kali's eyes! I... I had
greed... revenge!

A murmur ripples through the crowd. Some cover their mouths, others
exchange glances.

MAHANTA

The priest... he opposed me... (He
coughs, his voice raw) I killed him
too! I... I was the one who killed
him...

MAHANTA clutches his head and sinks to his knees. Sweat beads on his
forehead, tears stream down his face.

AARAV remains standing, watching MAHANTA.

SCENE 8

EXT. RAMABHADIPUR ANNUAL FAIR, POLICE STATION TENT - DAY

Characters: AARAV, MAHANTA, AARAV's Mother, AARAV's Grandmother, PRIYA, POLICE
INSPECTOR, REPORTER ¶rÅ \$U õ%DU" h, POLICE CONSTABLES, VILLAGERS

The sounds of panic still echo from the fairgrounds. Up ahead, inside
a large tent, a makeshift police station has been set up.

Two police constables escort MAHANTA (55, his face flushed with fear)

into the tent. He's in handcuffs.

MAHANTA keeps his eyes down. He avoids looking at the crowd.

A large crowd has gathered. Some are villagers, others are reporters, mics and cameras in hand.

AARAV (25, white shirt and jeans), his mother, grandmother, and PRIYA stand outside the tent. AARAV looks a bit weary, but his eyes hold a determined glint.

A Police Inspector (45, in uniform, stern face) steps forward. He surveys the crowd.

POLICE INSPECTOR

Listen, everyone. We've arrested
MAHANTA. An investigation will be
conducted.

The reporters surge forward, thrusting microphones towards the Inspector.

REPORTER ¶p

Sir, does AARAV have anything to say
about the priest's murder and the
theft of the Kali idol's eyes?

The Inspector turns to look at AARAV. AARAV glances at his mother. She gently squeezes his hand. His grandmother nods.

AARAV steps forward. The reporters swarm around him. He takes a deep breath.

AARAV

I have something to say.

MAHANTA glares at AARAV from inside the tent, his face darkening with rage.

AARAV

Today, the truth has come out. My
father was innocent. He never stole
the idol's eyes. He was framed.

A murmur ripples through the crowd. Some villagers' eyes well up with tears.

AARAV

MAHANTA's greed... his injustice, is
laid bare for all to see today. Kali
Maa herself has taken her revenge.

REPORTER ¶€

(ଉତ୍ସାହର ସହ)

Meaning... are you saying this was
divine retribution? (excitedly)

AARAV

(ନୀରବ ରହି)

The truth can never stay hidden.

Justice may be delayed, but it will
come. The stain on our village and my
father's name has been washed away
today. (pauses)

AARAV's mother and grandmother exchange a look. Their faces show a
sense of peace and pride.

PRIYA moves to AARAV's side and gently takes his hand. He looks at
her and gives a faint smile.

POLICE INSPECTOR

(ସାମ୍ବାଦିକଙ୍କୁ)

Please remain calm. The judiciary will
do its job. You may all leave. (to
reporters)

Constables lead MAHANTA towards a waiting vehicle behind the tent.
MAHANTA trembles.

AARAV looks off into the distance, as if seeing the distant peak of
the Kali temple.

SCENE 9

INT. KALI TEMPLE, RAMBHADIPUR - DAY

Characters: AARAV, AARAV'S MOTHER, AARAV'S GRANDMOTHER, PRIYA, PUJARI

A sense of peace and quiet pervades the temple. The scent of incense
fills the air. The gentle chime of temple bells drifts in.

AARAV (25, calm, dressed in a white dhoti-kurta) stands before the
inner sanctum.

Behind him are his MOTHER (50, in a white saree, a serene expression
settling on her tired face), his GRANDMOTHER (75, leaning on a cane,
a contented gleam in her eyes), and PRIYA (22, in a simple salwar
kameez, a bright look in her eyes).

An elderly PRIEST (60, white hair, trembling hands) sits before the
idol of Goddess Kali, chanting mantras.

He has placed the two eyes of the Mother Goddess, wrapped in silk
cloth, before him.

The priest gently unwraps them. Two glittering blue and red stones
are revealed.

AARAV stares intently into the empty sockets of the idol.

For a fleeting moment, a profound look crosses his face.

The priest, chanting softly, begins to place one eye into the idol's
socket.

Mother and Grandmother clasp hands. Their eyes well up.

The priest starts to place the second eye.

Just then, soft rays of sunlight stream into the temple.

The sunlight falls on the Mother Goddess's new eyes, and they begin to glow with a brilliant light.

The entire inner sanctum is illuminated.

AARAV's shoulders slump. He exhales slowly.

A gentle smile plays on his lips.

AARAV'S MOTHER

MOTHER: Mother... you heard our call.

The Grandmother lowers her head and joins her hands in prayer.

AARAV'S GRANDMOTHER

GRANDMOTHER: Everything is alright now, son. Your father's soul must be at peace.

PRIYA looks at AARAV.

Her face is alight with a bright smile and reverence.

PRIYA

PRIYA: What you did... it was impossible.

AARAV gently takes PRIYA's hand.

His gaze remains fixed on the Mother Goddess's illuminated eyes.

AARAV

AARAV: It wasn't me. It was Mother's will.

The sound of temple bells rises, now more powerful.

AARAV takes a deep breath.

A look of peace and contentment settles on his face.

The entire temple is bathed in the light radiating from the Mother Goddess's eyes.

His Mother, Grandmother, and PRIYA all gaze towards the idol, hands folded. The temple bells ring out even louder.